

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP & SUPPORTING EVIDENCE

Professor of Practice

Supporting Evidence & Strategic Vision
for the School of Design

Samarth K. Reddy

Associate Professor of Practice | School of Design

Graphic Era Deemed to be University

Prepared for the Dean, HR & Management

23 July 2026

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01

DOSSIER SECTION

Curriculum Vitae

INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

- Curriculum Vitae

SAMARTH K REDDY

iamsamarth@gmail.com | +91 966 320 0774 | +1 437 663 1181 | portfolio-5208db.webflow.io
Toronto, Canada | Dehradun, India

PROFILE

Hello there!

I'm Sam, I'm a designer and researcher with years of experience across professional practice and academia. These days, I'm deeply focused on designing for and with Artificial Intelligence.

I hold a Master's in Digital Futures from OCAD University (Canada) and another Master's in Product Design from Coventry University (UK), which gives me a unique lens on how we tackle modern design challenges. My work is all about finding new ways to create knowledge and helping others get comfortable with hands-on computational methods. Right now, I'm specifically looking at how AI and human memory intersect to build the next generation of memory-support tools.

 IN GB CA

EDUCATION

Master of Design (MDes), Digital Futures

09/2023 - 06/2025

OCAD University, Toronto, Canada

MSc, Product Design

Coventry University, Coventry, United Kingdom

RECENTLY ASSISTED / TAUGHT - LABS & STUDIOS

Dehradun, India - Graphic Era University (GEU)

Associate Professor of Practice: School of Design

Creative Coding: Generative visuals and interactive programming using p5.js (42 students)

Physical Computation: Hands-on electronics and prototyping with Arduino (42 students)

Design for and With AI: Vibe coding, model fine-tuning, and LoRA training; project-based studio course (42 students)

Toronto, Canada - OCAD University

Experiment Designer: ACE Lab, MAFA Project

Visual Communication Using AI for People with Disabilities: IDEA Hub

MRP Proposals: Inclusive Design studio (~20 students)

Inclusive Design in Convergences (~12 students)

Inclusive Design and Design Opportunities (~15 students)

Bangalore, India - Pearl Academy

Ergonomics and Human Factors: Studio project (5 students)

Immersive Technology (AR/VR): (5 students)

Physical Computation: Arduino prototyping, M.Des (13 students)

Gandhinagar, India - UID, Karnavati University

Technically Complex Product Design: Studio project, M.Des (17 students)

Introduction to Computing Systems: Arduino programming (39 students)

Digital Rendering: Keyshot and Photoshop (104 students)

Introduction to 3D Printing: Rhinoceros (700 students)

Mumbai, India - Pearl Academy

Future Labs: Studio project (40 students)

Usability in Practice (22 students)

Major Projects (28 students)

Minor Projects (42 students)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Associate Professor of Practice

07/2025 - Present

Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun, India

Joined the School of Design in its early stages to help develop the curriculum, organizational structure, and Board of Studies. Contributed to setting up the institution's AI Lab, Physical Computation Lab, and workshop spaces and other Infrastructural planning.

Research Assistant - Experiment Designer

11/2024 - 04/2025

ACE Lab, OCAD University, Toronto, Canada

Ministry of Agriculture, Food and Agribusiness (MAFA) Project. Designed experiments, developed evaluation criteria for AI/XR systems, and supported REB applications and research activities.

Graphic Designer

12/2024 - 05/2025

RBC Centre for Emerging Artists and Designers, OCAD University, Toronto, Canada

Designed event posters and digital assets for social media, website, and newsletters.

Industrial Designer & Consultant

11/2024 - 01/2025

SES Green | Gorrie, Toronto, Canada

Engineering consultation, mechanical CAD, 3D modelling, technical drawing, and rendering.

Graphic Designer (Volunteering)

11/2024 - 01/2025

Kannada Sangha Toronto (KST), Toronto, Canada

Created print and digital materials to enhance outreach and community engagement.

Design Mentor (Volunteering)

08/2024 - 12/2024

Will Employment Solutions, London, Canada

Guided immigrant talent entering design industries including 3D modelling, animation, graphic design, and industrial design.

Research Assistant - Graphic and Visual Designer

02/2024 - 06/2024

IDEA Hub 5, OCAD University, Toronto, Canada

AI equity research; visual communication using AI systems for people with disabilities; inclusive design.

Academic Assistant

09/2023 - 04/2024

Inclusive Design Masters Program, OCAD University, Toronto, Canada

MRP Proposals, Design Opportunities, Inclusive Design in Convergences.

Associate Professor (Consultant)

10/2022 - 08/2023

Pearl Academy, Bengaluru, India

Industrial Design, Communication Design, Interaction Design.

Associate Professor | External Reviewer**2021 - 2022**

University of Applied Sciences Europe, Berlin, Germany *(Remote)*

Visual & Experience Design.

Associate Professor**2021 - 2022**

Karnavati University - United World Institute of Design (UID), Gandhinagar, India

Industrial Design, Interaction Design.

Associate Professor**2017 - 2021**

Pearl Academy, Mumbai, India

Industrial Design.

Program Director**2013 - 2016**

Raffles College of Design & Commerce (RCDC), Singapore | Bangalore, India

Industrial Design.

Management Associate**2011 - 2012**

Geometric Ltd, Bengaluru | Pune | Chennai, India

Learning experience design for global engineering clients - Yanmar Marine, GE, MBRDI, Volvo 3P, GM, CAT, Airbus, Ford Visteon.

Roles: Product Designer · Instructional Designer · Learning Experience Designer

Faculty - PLM Learning Solutions**2010 - 2011**

EDS Technologies, Bangalore | Visakhapatnam, India

Corporate training for John Deere, Daimler Chrysler AG, Boeing, Dassault Systèmes, NAL, HAL, ISRO, L&T CE.

Roles: Product Designer · Instructional Designer · Learning Experience Designer

Sr. CAD Engineer**2009 - 2010**

EduCADD Pvt Ltd, Bengaluru, India

Product design, instructional design, learning experience.

CAD Engineer**2008**

Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL) | ProSim R&D, Bengaluru, India

Mechanical CAD, product design, instructional design.

ADMINISTRATION EXPERIENCE

Graphic Era Deemed to be University (2025 - Present)**Board of Studies member:** Design School setup, curriculum structure, and lab establishment**OCAD University (2023 - 2025)****REB (Research Ethics Board) application support:** ACE Lab, MAFA Project**Research administration and experiment design coordination:** IDEA Hub, AI equity research

Academic assistance across MRP Proposals, Design Opportunities, and Inclusive Design in Convergences

Pearl Academy (2022 - 2023)

Coordination and curriculum development for Industrial Design

University of Applied Sciences Europe (2021 - 2022)

External examiner for a Master's thesis in Visual & Experience Design (Remote)

UID / Karnavati University (2021 - 2022)

Curriculum development, assessment, and accreditation compliance

Chair, Portfolio Assessment Team (July: August 2022)* - managed student portfolio review and assessment

Pearl Academy (2017 - 2021)

Led thesis supervision, faculty training, and student mentorship

Industry Liaison & Placement Support: facilitated internships, campus recruitment, industry collaborations, and marketing outreach

Raffles College of Design & Commerce (2013 - 2016)

Program Director, Product Design: managed team, curriculum oversight, and academic planning

EDS Technologies (2010 - 2011)

Coordinated corporate training for major clients (John Deere, Boeing, ISRO): customisation, delivery, and feedback analysis

Geometric Ltd (2011 - 2012)

Oversaw learning experience design for global engineering clients (GE, GM, Ford, Volvo): managed timelines and multi-functional teams

WORKSHOPS & TRAINING SESSIONS

AI for Design: Integrating AI tools into the design process across ideation, prototyping, and visual communication

Fine-Tuning AI Models: Custom model training and fine-tuning for design-specific outputs using open-source frameworks

ComfyUI: Node-based workflow design for Stable Diffusion image generation, including custom pipelines and automation

Vibe Coding with AI: AI-assisted creative coding using LLM-based tools for rapid prototyping and generative experiments

Training with Open-Source AI Models: Hands-on training with open-source models including LoRA, embeddings, and dataset preparation

ADPList Mentor: Mentored early- to senior-level designers globally in professional development

Generative Storytelling with AI: Narrative-driven experiences using GPT, MidJourney, Stable Diffusion, and Riffusion

Human-Centred AI: Designing AI systems with usability, empathy, accessibility, and ethics using Microsoft's HAX Toolkit

Computational & Generative Design: Parametric modelling and algorithmic workflows using Grasshopper 3D and Rhinoceros

Creative Coding for Designers: Generative art and interactive graphics using p5.js and Processing

3D Printing for Creatives: Digital fabrication, CAD modelling, and additive manufacturing

Finite Element Analysis (FEA): Stress-strain analysis, cantilever beam testing, part and assembly analysis, material optimisation

Arduino 101: Basics of physical computing, IoT, and interactive prototyping

Alter Ego in Design: Exploring personal design identity and creative expression

Teach the Teachers: Faculty training on research ethics, academic integrity, and research methodologies

Transportation Design Sketching: Perspective, proportions, style, marker techniques, and visualisation fundamentals

Rendering Techniques: Advanced digital visualisation using Cinema 4D, Keyshot, and Photoshop

CAD Modelling: Precision 3D modelling for industrial design using CATIA, CREO, and Rhinoceros

CURRENT WORK - PROJECTS

AI & Extended Reality

Mind Palace XR (2026)AR application transforming real-world surroundings into interactive 3D memory aids / *Key Tools: Unity, Google Gemini AI, FalAI, StabilityAI, GLTFast*

Memory Atlas (2026)Personal productivity and geospatial journaling tool / *Key Tools: Spatial Memory, Mapping*

Face-Based Image Sorter (2026)Automated face recognition and image organisation / *Key Tools: Machine Learning, Computer Vision, Data Engineering*

OMAF: AI & XR Evaluation (2025)Evaluation framework for AI and XR systems / *Key Tools: Government of Canada, ACE Lab*

Computational Semiotics (2025)AI-based visual and semiotic analysis

Real-Time Webcam Captioning (2025)Live computer vision captioning / *Key Tools: LLaVA, Phi-3, Ollama*

From Noise to Art (2025)The emergence of diffusion models in image synthesis / *Key Tools: Generative AI, LoRA Training, AI Art*

YOLO Diffusion (2025)Custom YOLO model training for visual object detection

ControlNet (2025)Structural guidance for image generation / *Key Tools: Stable Diffusion, ControlNet*

Text to 3D Model (2025)AI-powered 3D model generation from prompts / *Key Tools: Meshy.ai API, Node.js, Google Model Viewer*

Frame Vision Maps (2025)AI-driven image capture and location mapping / *Key Tools: Brilliant Labs Frame, LLaVA AI, OpenStreetMap, Python*

BLIP vs Human Captions (2025)Comparative evaluation of AI and human image captioning / *Key Tools: BLIP, LoRA*

Memory Maps (2025)Enhanced interactive spatial memory visualisation / *Key Tools: React, Leaflet, Tailwind CSS, TypeScript*

Webcam to AI Captions (2025)Real-time AI-powered visual description / *Key Tools: Computer Vision, Ollama*

Image to Captions (2025)Automated image captioning pipeline / *Key Tools: LLaVA, AI Text Generation*

AI for 3D Modelling (2024)AI-enhanced workflow for streamlined 3D rendering / *Key Tools: Stable Diffusion, LoRA, 3D Modelling*

AI-Driven VR NPCs (2024)Convergence of VR and AI for life-like non-player characters / *Key Tools: Unreal Engine, AI*

Physical Computation & Applied Research

Compute. Couture (2024)Wearable kinetic art / *Key Tools: Arduino*

Compute. Art (2024)Interactive installation art / *Key Tools: p5.js*

Compute. Play (2024)Kinetic puppetry exploring computer vision and physical computing / *Key Tools: Arduino, Processing*

Compute. Sound (2024)Sound-to-form generative experiments / *Key Tools: Physical Computing*

Compute. Detox (2024)Meditative digital detox installation / *Key Tools: p5.js*

Bio-Morphologies (2024)Biomimicry-based creative ideation technique / *Key Tools: Research Methods, Workshop*

Nakuko Obelisk (2023)Interactive lighting installation

Parametric Prosthesis (2023)Assistive technology through parametric design / *Key Tools: Grasshopper, Rhinoceros*

Generative Reverb (2023)Sound-based form generation through acoustic computation

Alter-Ego in Design (2023)Exploring personal design identity and creative expression

Hive Mind (2023)Collaborative installation art

Node Parameters (2023)Parametric and generative design explorations / *Key Tools: Grasshopper, Blender*

Narrative Exploration & Sketches

Computational MythosSpeculative design narratives

Xeno Morphology Concept architecture and alien morphology sketches

Algorithmic Modelling Generative 3D form studies

Fictional Narratives Sci-fi sketches and speculative world-building

Character Stories Character design and illustration

Illustrative Sketches Industrial design sketching and visualisation

Industrial Design Prompts Generator AI-assisted ID sprint tool

CURRENT WORK - WRITING

From Method of Loci to Digital Mnemonics: AI, AR, and the Future of Memory*

From Noise to Art: The Emergence of Diffusion Models in Image Synthesis*

AI Model Training: Stable Diffusion Style Preservation*

Acoustic Morphologies: Sound-Based Form Generation Through Computation: NIME

AI-Driven VR NPCs: Convergence of Virtual Reality and Artificial Intelligence in Games: A New Paradigm in Life-Like NPCs*

Evaluation of LoRA Training in Kohya SS for Stable Diffusion

Evolutionary Problem Solving with Artificial Intelligence and Generative Design

PROFESSIONAL PROJECTS

Industry Projects

Industrial Designer and Consultant: Gorrie.

Multiple Projects: Mercedes-Benz Research & Development India (MBRDI)

Robotics / Automation: Ford Motors (Visteon)

Class A: B Surfaces - General Motors

Body Panel Surfaces: John Deere

Mechanisms: Caterpillar (CAT)

Class A Surfaces: Daimler Chrysler AG

Aerofoil & Turbine Blades: General Electric (GE)

High Pressure Cylinders: Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL)

Engine Parts: Yanmar Marine International

CAA Programming: Dassault Systèmes

Engineering Digital Assets: Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL)

Chandrayaan-1 Mechanisms: Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

Rail Gun: Indian Institute of Science (IISc)

Nuclear Submarine Digital Assets: Indian Navy, Larsen & Toubro (L&T CE)

Generative Design: Design Morphine

Academic Curriculum Development: Pearl Academy

Module / Subject Development: Pearl Academy

Interactive Installations: Raffles College of Design and Commerce

Defence Design Curriculum: UID

SKILLS

Research	Theoretical context, analytical thinking, data analysis, documentation, ethics
Design Tools	Adobe Suite, Autodesk Products, Rhinoceros 3D, Keyshot, Substance, Cinema 4D
Artificial Intelligence	Stable Diffusion, LoRA training, embeddings, fine-tuning
User Experience	User research, information architecture, wireframing, prototyping, accessibility, Figma
IoT & Physical Computing	Arduino, TinkerCAD, Fritzing
Programming	p5.js, Processing, HTML & CSS, Cursor AI
XR Technologies	3D modelling & texturing, Unity, Unreal Engine, A-Frame
Parametric & Generative	Grasshopper, Blender Geometry Nodes, CATIA, Fusion 360
Speculative Design	Opportunity mapping, fictional narratives, foresight analysis, diegesis
Pedagogy	Curriculum development, problem-based learning, experiential & lecture-based learning
Industry Training	Design Thinking, CAD with CATIA, FEA, CFD

CERTIFICATIONS

140+ completed · 2 in progress

Technology & AI: IBM, Big Data, IoT, Bluestone Tech Labs, Futureskills

Design & Visualisation: Domestika, Udemy; parametric design, 3D modelling, illustration

Research: SG Research Academy, Psychline; research design, psychology, TCPS

Professional Development: LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, Kaarwan, Skillnation, Fobet

Compliance & Accessibility: AODA

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

2022: Top 30 Percentile globally, International Teachers' Olympiad

2022: Top 10 Educator, International School Awards

2021: Certificate of Appreciation, Taiwan International Student Design Competition

2021: People's Choice: Most Eccentric - Pearl Academy

2021: People's Choice: Tech Maverick - Pearl Academy

2021: People's Choice: Best Sense of Humour - Pearl Academy

2021: Academic Gravitas: Highest Mentoring Quality - Pearl Academy

2021: Academic Gravitas: Highest Teaching Quality - Pearl Academy

2021: Academic Gravitas: Best Mentor - Pearl Academy

2017: Research Award, Pearl Academy - *"Behavior Sensitive Lighting Reactive to Generational Dimensional Spaces"*

MENTORED PROJECT AWARDS

Kara 108RG - Flood Emergency Equipment (*Shraddha Kumbhar*)

Featured in Dezeen Design Magazine

Showcased in Asia Today and Disruptive Asia

Most Professional Project Award: Pearl Academy Annual Portfolio Showcase

Product showcased at Global Grad Show, Dubai Design Week

Official Selection, Global Grad Show: curated by Caroline Roux, London-based design journalist

Showcased at Pune Design Festival, Edutainment, and Portfolio events

Artemis 389 - Patient Transfer Equipment (*Anuja Tripathi*)

Gold Award: IDA Design Award

Finalist: TISDC Student Design Competition

Finalist: Berlin UX Design Awards

Winner: DNA Paris Awards

Shortlist: Red Dot Concepts Awards

Finalist: IXDA Awards

Official Selection: London International Creative Competition (LICC)

Featured in IF World Design Guide

Top Award Winner: European Product Design Awards (EPDA)

Second Runner-up, Product Design: ADI at Pune Design Festival Awards

Design Intelligence Award, 2022

Budding Buddy - Furniture for Children with ADHD (*Shivani Jadhav*)

First Prize: Awwchitecture Design Competition

First Prize, Furniture Design: Association of Designers of India at Pune Design Festival

Carapace - Post-Disaster Shelter Unit (*Vaishnavi Shiroorkar*)

TISDC Award, 2022

Winner: European Product Design Awards (EPDA), 2023

DNA Paris Design Award, 2023

Project Drop, Surgical Mask & Milch (*Vihaan Shinde, Maha Vustala & Anika Patel - mentored by SK Reddy and V Garg*)

5th Prize and 2 Commendations: Coventry University Global Sustainability Challenge, 2022

02

DOSSIER SECTION

Proposal: Establishment of 14 Research Labs

INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

- Proposal: Establishment of 14 Research Labs

Proposal: Establishment of Research Labs - School of Design

Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun

Submitted to: The Dean, School of Design Graphic Era Deemed to be University Dehradun, Uttarakhand, India

Proposed by: **Samarth K Reddy** Associate Professor of Practice, School of Design Graphic Era Deemed to be University <https://portfolio-5208db.webflow.io/>

Date of Submission: 18 February 2026

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1. Introduction and Purpose

This proposal seeks formal approval to establish a suite of **fourteen Research Labs** within the **School of Design** at Graphic Era Deemed to be University. These labs are designed to be formal research organisations led by faculty, each centred around a specific theme of design innovation that advances the School's academic mission, applied project outcomes, and societal impact.

Each lab will operate for a **minimum initial term of three years** and will provide **annual reports** on activities, outputs, and financial accounting to the **Dean, School of Design**.

1.1 Rationale

The School of Design is uniquely positioned to lead interdisciplinary research that bridges traditional craft, emerging technologies, social impact, and entrepreneurial practice. Currently, research activities within the

School are distributed across individual faculty portfolios without a unifying organisational framework. The establishment of themed research labs will:

- **Consolidate and focus** research efforts around clearly defined domains of design innovation.
- **Attract external funding** through dedicated, recognisable research entities with distinct identities.
- **Enhance student development** by embedding research opportunities within structured lab environments.
- **Elevate institutional visibility** through nationally and internationally recognised lab identities.
- **Align with NEP 2020** mandates for multidisciplinary research infrastructure in higher education.

1.2 Scope

This proposal outlines **fourteen Research Labs**, each addressing a distinct area of design research. The labs span the full breadth of the School of Design's disciplinary expertise - Product Design, Interior Design, Graphic Design, Fashion Design - while creating interdisciplinary intersections with engineering, computer science, humanities, life sciences, and management.

1.3 Summary of Proposed Labs

#	Abbr.	Lab Name	Focus Area
1	GLANCE	Graphic Language and New Communication Ecosystems	Printmaking, Digital and New Media, Visual Arts and Design, Screen Aesthetics, Editorial and Publication Design, and Typography
2	ECHO	Ecosystems for Contemporary Handicrafts & Operations (cross-disciplinary innovation lab)	Technical tool ergonomics, workshop safety, and production system scaling for traditional handicrafts
3	SAGE	Synergistic AI & Generative Engines	Generative AI (LLMs, Diffusion, GANs) applied to human memory research
4	CARE	Community Action for Rural Empowerment	Social design for rural empowerment - sanitation, housing, and education in hilly regions
5	BREAKEVEN	Entrepreneurial Design Lab	Bridging design studio practice with entrepreneurship, startups, and MSME consultancy
6	VITAL	Visualising Innovative Technologies for Applied Life-sciences	Biophilic design and biomimicry - learning from nature to inform design practice
7	PRISM	Practice Research & Inquiry in Systematic Methods	Creating, testing, validating, and documenting new design research methods, methodologies, and frameworks
8	PORTAL	Platform for Omni-Reality Technologies and Applied Learning	AR, VR, and Mixed Reality for immersive design, spatial computing, and heritage preservation
9	SPARK	Studio for Play, Animation, Research & Kinetics	Animation, game design, VFX, and interactive digital storytelling
10	HEAL	Health Experiences & Applied Life-design	Health design - patient experience, medical devices, and public health communication
11	REACH	Research in Equity, Accessibility, Capability & Human-centred design	Inclusive design research - accessibility, equity, and assistive technology for all
12	POLIS	Practice, Observation & Living Institutions in Service design policies	Design for governance and public services - citizen experience, Digital India, and public information design
13	VISTA	Visions, Imagination, Scenarios & Thinking Ahead	Speculative design, design futures, scenario building, and critical design inquiry

14	SPACE	Scenography, Performing Arts & Creative Environments	Performance architecture, kinetic body tracking, and sensory environmental stagecraft for live events
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2. Proposed Research Labs

Lab 1: GLANCE - Graphic Language and New Communication Ecosystems

Theme: Printmaking, Digital and New Media, Visual Arts and Design, Screen Aesthetics, Editorial and Publication Design, and Typography.

Rationale: Modern communication ecosystems require an integrated approach that spans tactile print processes, digital screens, and expressive visual languages. The GLANCE Lab will research typography, publication design, and visual arts at the intersection of traditional print media and new screen-based technologies.

Planned Activities:

- Research into letterpress typography and contemporary printmaking techniques.
- Investigating screen aesthetics, user interfaces, and digital publication platforms.
- Editorial design projects, visual storytelling, and advanced layout methodologies.
- Creating new typographical systems for multilingual communication in India.
- Exhibition design and curation of visual art installations.

Requirements:

- Printmaking equipment (presses, screen-printing screens, squeegees, exposure units).
- High-resolution digital printers, paper cutting/guillotine machines, bookbinding tools.
- Color-calibrated monitors and graphic design workstations.
- Subscriptions/licenses for professional typefoundries and publishing suites.

Lab 2: ECHO - Ecosystems for Contemporary Handicrafts & Operations (cross-disciplinary innovation lab)

Theme: Technical tool ergonomics, workshop safety, and production system scaling for traditional handicrafts.

Rationale: Traditional handicraft sectors in India face critical challenges in operational efficiency, safety, and physical ergonomics. The ECHO Lab focuses on design-led interventions that improve artisan health through ergonomic tool design, establish workshop safety protocols, and scale production systems without compromising cultural authenticity.

Planned Activities:

- Ergonomic redesign of traditional artisan tools (weaving looms, woodcarving tools, pottery wheels) to reduce musculoskeletal strain.
- Development of low-cost workshop safety devices, dust extraction systems, and ventilation units for artisan workspaces.

- Design of modular jigs, templates, and production fixtures to scale craft output and improve quality.
- Field studies on posture-related strain and occupational hazards in craft clusters.
- Collaborating with state and national craft development agencies to deploy safety guidelines and capacity building.

Requirements:

- Posture and movement analysis sensors (inertial measurement units, motion cameras).
- Fabrication tools for tool prototyping (metal, wood, and plastic working equipment).
- Dust extraction systems, noise level meters, and light intensity meters.
- Collection storage for craft tools, workspace templates, and ergonomics data.

Collaborators:

- Artisan collectives, handloom cooperatives, and NGO partners.
 - Department of Mechanical Engineering (for structural fabrication and prototyping).
 - National Institute of Design (NID), DC (Handicrafts), and state handloom boards.
-

Lab 3: SAGE - Synergistic AI & Generative Engines

Theme: Generative AI - Large Language Models, Diffusion Models, Generative Adversarial Networks, and other foundation models - applied to the study and augmentation of Human Memory.

Rationale: Generative AI is reshaping every creative and cognitive domain. The SAGE Lab investigates the intersection of generative AI systems and human memory - exploring how LLMs, diffusion models, GANs, and multimodal foundation models can be used to encode, retrieve, reconstruct, and augment human memory processes. This lab positions the School of Design at the frontier of AI-memory research, a field with profound implications for education, healthcare, cognitive accessibility, and personal knowledge management.

Planned Activities:

- Research into AI-driven memory encoding, retrieval, and reconstruction using LLMs, diffusion models, and GANs.
- Development of generative AI tools for personal memory augmentation - transforming fragmented recollections into coherent visual, textual, and spatial narratives.
- Investigating the role of AI-generated imagery (via Stable Diffusion, DALL·E, Midjourney-class models) in false memory formation and memory distortion.
- Exploring GAN-based facial and scene reconstruction from partial memory descriptions for forensic and therapeutic applications.
- Research into the ethics of AI-mediated memory - consent, authenticity, manipulation, and the right to forget.
- Developing AI-assisted journaling and life-logging systems that leverage LLMs for reflective memory practice.
- Benchmarking generative model fidelity against human memory accuracy across demographic and cognitive profiles.

Requirements:

- High-performance computing (HPC) resources with GPU clusters (NVIDIA A100/H100 equivalent) for training and fine-tuning large generative models.
- Access to cloud computing platforms (AWS, GCP, Azure) for scalable inference workloads.

- Software licenses and API access for AI/ML frameworks (PyTorch, TensorFlow, Hugging Face, Stability AI, OpenAI API).
-

Lab 4: CARE - Community Action for Rural Empowerment

Theme: Social Design for rural hilly regions of Uttarakhand and beyond.

Rationale: Aligned with the School of Design's mission for social impact, the CARE Lab focuses on applying design thinking and participatory design methods to address the real-world challenges faced by rural communities in hilly terrain. This lab embodies the principle that design is not merely an aesthetic or commercial discipline but a powerful tool for social transformation.

Planned Activities:

- Designing low-cost, culturally appropriate sanitation solutions for rural hill communities.
- Developing sustainable rural housing models adapted to Himalayan geography and climate.
- Creating pedagogical tools and learning environments for rural schools with limited infrastructure.
- Participatory design workshops with rural communities to co-create solutions.
- Research on disaster preparedness and resilient infrastructure design for hill regions.

Mode of Operation:

- Primarily field-based research conducted in partnership with rural communities, local government bodies, and NGOs.
 - Six-month immersive field studios for student researchers.
 - Close coordination with the university's NSS and community outreach programmes.
-

Lab 5: BREAKEVEN - Entrepreneurial Design Lab

Theme: Bridging design studio practice and commercial viability.

Rationale: The term "Breakeven" captures the precise moment where a creative venture transitions from investment to sustainability. This lab addresses the critical gap between design education and entrepreneurial practice, equipping students and faculty with the knowledge and infrastructure to translate design innovation into commercially viable products, services, and ventures.

Planned Activities:

- Supporting student-led design startups from ideation through prototyping to market launch.
- Research into "Design Management" - the strategic integration of design into business operations and decision-making.
- Providing design consultancy services for local MSMEs (Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises) in Dehradun and Uttarakhand.
- Developing case studies on successful design-led enterprises in the Indian context.
- Hosting pitch events, design sprints, and entrepreneurship workshops.

Financial Structure:

- Will require a management structure to handle potential commercialisation revenues, consultancy income, and associated overheads.

- Revenue-sharing framework to be developed in coordination with the university's Finance Division and Incubation Centre.
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Lab 6: VITAL - Visualising Innovative Technologies for Applied Life-sciences

Theme: Biophilic Design and Biomimicry - learning from nature to inform and transform design practice.

Rationale: Nature has spent 3.8 billion years refining solutions to structural, thermal, material, and systemic challenges. Biophilic design - the integration of natural elements, patterns, and principles into the built and designed environment - has been shown to improve wellbeing, productivity, and cognitive function. Biomimicry - the practice of emulating nature's strategies to solve human design problems - offers a rigorous, evidence-based methodology for innovation. The VITAL Lab brings these two disciplines together within the School of Design, creating a dedicated research centre for nature-informed design across products, interiors, graphics, and fashion.

Planned Activities:

- Research into biophilic design principles for interior spaces - natural light optimisation, biomorphic forms, material palettes, and sensory environments that enhance human wellbeing.
- Biomimicry-driven product design - studying biological structures (bone lattices, leaf venation, shell geometries) to develop lightweight, efficient, and sustainable product forms.
- Development of a **Biomimicry Design Toolkit** - a structured methodology and resource library for designers to systematically translate biological principles into design solutions.
- Research into nature-inspired pattern systems for graphic and textile design - generative algorithms derived from natural growth patterns (phyllotaxis, Voronoi, reaction-diffusion).
- Biophilic wayfinding and environmental graphics research - how nature-informed signage and spatial cues improve navigation and reduce stress in healthcare, educational, and commercial environments.
- Collaboration with the Department of Biotechnology and Environmental Science on biological research that informs design applications.

Requirements:

- Nature specimen library and biological reference collection (shells, seeds, bones, plant structures).
 - High-resolution microscopy (digital microscope, macro photography rig) for studying biological structures at micro and macro scales.
 - Computational design workstations with parametric modelling software (Grasshopper, Rhino) for translating biological geometries into design forms.
 - Environmental simulation software for testing biophilic design interventions (daylight analysis, thermal comfort, acoustic modelling).
-

Lab 7: PRISM - Practice Research & Inquiry in Systematic Methods

Theme: Design research methods, methodologies, and frameworks - developing, validating, and disseminating new approaches to user research and design inquiry.

Rationale: Just as a prism refracts light into its constituent wavelengths - revealing hidden structure in what appears uniform - PRISM diffracts complex design problems into measurable, testable, and communicable

research dimensions. Design as a discipline lacks a unified, rigorous body of research methods comparable to the sciences or social sciences. Most design programmes teach borrowed methods (from anthropology, psychology, or HCI) without critically examining their fitness for design-specific contexts. The PRISM Lab addresses this foundational gap by focusing on the creation, testing, validation, and documentation of **new design research methods, methodologies, and frameworks** - contributing to the epistemological advancement of design as an academic discipline.

Planned Activities:

- Development of new user research methods tailored to the Indian design context - accounting for linguistic diversity, cultural norms, digital literacy gaps, and rural-urban divides.
- Creation and validation of novel design research frameworks - structured approaches for design ethnography, participatory design, speculative design research, and design-led futures thinking.
- Comparative studies of existing design research methodologies - evaluating the effectiveness, reliability, and cultural transferability of methods such as contextual inquiry, cultural probes, co-design workshops, and diary studies.
- Development of standardised user research testing protocols for the Indian market - usability benchmarks, heuristic evaluation frameworks, and design audit methodologies.
- Producing open-access toolkits, method cards, and teaching resources that make validated methods usable by the broader design research community.
- Hosting annual **Design Methods Symposium** - a national forum for presenting and debating new approaches to design inquiry.
- Eye-tracking studies, A/B testing frameworks, and survey instrument design for quantitative and mixed-methods user research.

Requirements:

- Eye-tracking hardware and software (e.g., Tobii Pro) for gaze analysis and attention mapping.
 - Multi-angle video recording setup and one-way observation mirror within the allocated lab space.
 - Survey and data analysis software (Qualtrics, SPSS, R, NVivo for qualitative analysis).
 - Prototyping tools for creating research instruments and stimuli (physical and digital).
-

Lab 8: PORTAL - Platform for Omni-Reality Technologies and Applied Learning

Theme: Extended Reality (XR) - Augmented Reality, Virtual Reality, and Mixed Reality - for immersive design, education, cultural heritage, and spatial computing.

Rationale: Extended Reality technologies are redefining how humans interact with information, space, and each other. The PORTAL Lab establishes a dedicated research environment for AR, VR, and MR applications across all design disciplines - from immersive interior walkthroughs and virtual product prototyping to heritage preservation through digital twins and accessible learning environments. As XR hardware becomes increasingly affordable and powerful, the School of Design must develop the research capacity to lead, not follow, this transformation.

Planned Activities:

- Development of immersive VR environments for interior design visualisation and spatial prototyping.
- AR-based brand storytelling, exhibition design, and retail experience research.
- Creation of digital twins for cultural heritage sites across Uttarakhand using photogrammetry and VR reconstruction.

- Research into XR-based pedagogical tools for design education - virtual studios, remote critique environments, and collaborative design spaces.
- Motion capture and spatial interaction research for product ergonomics and user experience.
- Investigating accessibility in XR - designing inclusive immersive experiences for persons with disabilities.
- Collaborative projects with SAGE Lab on AI-enhanced XR experiences (e.g., AI-driven memory palaces in VR).

Requirements:

- VR headsets (Meta Quest 3/Pro, HTC Vive Pro) and AR devices (Microsoft HoloLens 2, Magic Leap 2).
 - Motion capture system (Perception Neuron or equivalent) for spatial interaction research.
 - 360-degree cameras (Insta360 Pro) and depth cameras (Intel RealSense) for immersive content capture.
 - High-performance rendering workstations with Unity Pro and Unreal Engine licenses.
-

Lab 9: SPARK - Studio for Play, Animation, Research & Kinetics

Theme: Animation, Game Design, Visual Effects (VFX), and interactive digital storytelling.

Rationale: A spark is the ignition point - the precise moment a creative idea catches fire and becomes a world. The SPARK Lab honours this moment, establishing a research and production environment where animation, game mechanics, real-time rendering, and visual effects are studied and advanced as design disciplines, not merely technical skills. The global animation, gaming, and VFX industry is one of the fastest-growing creative sectors, projected to exceed \$500 billion by 2030. India is rapidly emerging as a global hub for animation and VFX production, yet design schools have been slow to establish dedicated research infrastructure in these domains. The SPARK Lab fills this gap.

Planned Activities:

- Research into narrative design and interactive storytelling - how game mechanics, branching narratives, and player agency create meaningful user experiences.
- Development of indie game prototypes as design research vehicles - exploring themes of culture, heritage, mental health, and social awareness through playable experiences.
- Advanced VFX research - procedural generation, particle systems, fluid simulations, and real-time compositing techniques for film and advertising.
- 2D and 3D character animation research - motion studies, expressive animation, and the application of animation principles to UI/UX micro-interactions.
- Research into serious games and gamification - educational games for rural schools (with CARE Lab), rehabilitation games for healthcare (with HEAL Lab), and gamified design tools.
- Real-time rendering research using Unreal Engine and Unity - photorealistic visualisation for architecture, product design, and brand experiences.

Requirements:

- High-performance workstations with dedicated GPUs (RTX 4080/4090) for rendering and real-time engine work.
- Professional animation software licenses (Maya, Blender, ZBrush, Houdini, After Effects, Nuke).
- Game engine licenses (Unity Pro, Unreal Engine).
- Drawing tablets (Wacom Cintiq) and motion capture system access (shared with PORTAL).

- Sound design equipment (audio interface, microphones, monitoring headphones) for game audio research.

Lab 10: HEAL - Health Experiences & Applied Life-design

Theme: Health Design - the application of design thinking, service design, and product innovation to healthcare systems, patient experience, and public health.

Rationale: Healthcare is one of the most complex and consequential design challenges of our time. From the layout of a hospital ward to the interface of a diagnostic app, from the packaging of medication to the experience of a patient navigating a public health system - design decisions directly impact health outcomes, particularly in resource-constrained settings like India. The HEAL Lab establishes a dedicated research centre for Health Design, positioning the School of Design to contribute meaningfully to India's healthcare transformation.

Planned Activities:

- Patient experience design - researching and redesigning the end-to-end journey of patients through healthcare facilities, from wayfinding and registration to treatment and discharge.
- Medical product and device design - human-centred design of low-cost diagnostic tools, assistive devices, prosthetics, and rehabilitation equipment.
- Healthcare service design - mapping and redesigning healthcare delivery systems for primary health centres, community clinics, and telemedicine platforms in rural India.
- Mental health design interventions - designing therapeutic environments, digital mental health tools, and sensory spaces for stress reduction and cognitive wellbeing.
- Public health communication design - visual systems for health literacy, vaccination awareness, nutrition education, and epidemic preparedness tailored to diverse Indian audiences.
- Design for ageing - products, environments, and services that support dignity, independence, and quality of life for India's rapidly growing elderly population.

Requirements:

- Service design and journey mapping tools (physical and digital - large-format whiteboards, Miro/FigJam licenses).
- Prototyping infrastructure for medical devices (shared with MIND Lab for material testing).
- Simulation mannequins and patient experience testing props.
- Biometric sensors (heart rate, galvanic skin response, EEG) for measuring user responses to designed healthcare environments.

Collaborators:

- Department of Nursing and Allied Health Sciences, Graphic Era University.
 - Local hospitals and primary health centres in Dehradun and Uttarakhand.
 - Public health NGOs and government health departments.
-

Lab 11: REACH - Research in Equity, Accessibility, Capability & Human-centred design

Theme: Inclusive Design - research into design systems, products, services, and environments that are accessible, equitable, and usable by the widest possible range of people.

Rationale: REACH captures the dual ambition of this lab: to extend the reach of design to those most often excluded, and to reach across disciplines, methods, and communities to make inclusion a systemic reality rather than an afterthought. India, with its extraordinary diversity of ability, age, language, literacy, culture, and socioeconomic context, urgently needs design research that centres the needs of those who are most often left behind. The REACH Lab establishes a permanent, dedicated space for this critical work - grounding all research in the Indian context while drawing from international best practices in inclusive and universal design.

Planned Activities:

- Research into accessible product design - physical products, packaging, interfaces, and environments designed for persons with visual, auditory, motor, and cognitive disabilities.
- Development of Inclusive Design frameworks and guidelines for the Indian context - bridging international standards (WCAG, ISO 21542, ADA) with India's Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 and the Accessible India Campaign.
- Co-design research with marginalised communities - participatory design with persons with disabilities, elderly populations, rural communities, and economically disadvantaged groups.
- Universal Design audits of public spaces, educational institutions, and commercial environments - developing assessment tools and remediation guidelines.
- Research into inclusive digital design - accessible websites, mobile applications, and digital services for India's diverse population, including low-literacy and multilingual users.
- Assistive technology innovation - designing low-cost, culturally appropriate assistive devices for the Indian market.
- Inclusive design education research - developing curricula, teaching methods, and assessment frameworks for embedding inclusive thinking across all design programmes.

Requirements:

- Accessibility testing equipment - screen readers, switch access devices, magnification tools, assistive input devices for testing across disability types.
- Adjustable and adaptive furniture for inclusive co-design sessions.
- Accessibility simulation kits (vision impairment simulators, mobility restriction devices, ageing simulation suits).
- Assistive technology prototyping components (haptic actuators, audio modules, tactile interfaces).

Collaborators:

- National Centre for Promotion of Employment for Disabled People (NCPEDP).
- Department of Disability Studies and Rehabilitation Sciences (partner institutions).
- Disability rights organisations and self-advocacy groups.

Lab 12: POLIS - Practice, Observation & Living Institutions in Service design policies

Theme: Design for Governance and Public Services - applying design thinking, service design, and information design to improve citizen experience and government service delivery.

Rationale: *Polis* - the ancient Greek city-state - was the original unit of designed civic life: a place where governance, public space, and citizen experience were inseparable by definition. India's digital public infrastructure - UPI, Aadhaar, DigiLocker, CoWIN, ONDC, GeM - is globally unprecedented in scale and ambition. Yet the design of citizen-facing government services remains vastly under-researched. The POLIS Lab positions the School of Design to contribute meaningfully to India's governance transformation, researching how design can make public services more accessible, efficient, and equitable for 1.4 billion citizens.

Planned Activities:

- Citizen experience research - mapping and redesigning the end-to-end journey of citizens interacting with government services (ration cards, land records, healthcare, education enrolment, tax filing).
- Public information design - visual systems for government schemes, health advisories, disaster preparedness, and financial literacy tailored to India's linguistically diverse and multi-literate population.
- Digital India interface research - UX analysis and redesign recommendations for government apps and portals (UMANG, DigiLocker, mParivahan, eNAM) with a focus on accessibility and low-literacy users.
- Service design for Smart Cities - wayfinding systems, public transit interfaces, citizen feedback mechanisms, and urban information design.
- Research into design policy - how national and state governments can embed design thinking into policy formulation, public procurement, and service delivery frameworks.
- E-governance dashboard and data visualisation design - making complex government data comprehensible and actionable for policymakers and citizens.

Requirements:

- Service design and journey mapping tools (physical and digital - large-format whiteboards, Miro/FigJam licenses).
- User research infrastructure (screen recording, remote usability testing, survey platforms).
- Data visualisation software and workstations.
- Field research budget for citizen experience mapping across urban and rural contexts.

Collaborators:

- District administration and municipal bodies in Dehradun and Uttarakhand.
- Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) - Digital India initiatives.
- National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA) and Smart Cities Mission.
- National e-Governance Division (NeGD).

Lab 13: VISTA - Visions, Imagination, Scenarios & Thinking Ahead

Theme: Speculative Design, Design Futures, Critical Design, and Scenario Building - imagining and prototyping alternative futures through design.

Rationale: A vista is not just a view - it is the full sweep of what lies ahead, the panoramic perspective that reveals not one path but many. While most design labs solve today's problems, the VISTA Lab asks: *what kind of futures are we designing toward?* Speculative design and design futures are among the most intellectually rigorous areas of contemporary design research, yet almost no Indian institution has a dedicated lab in this space. The VISTA Lab fills this gap, positioning Graphic Era as a pioneer in futures-oriented design inquiry in India.

Planned Activities:

- Speculative design projects that prototype alternative futures for India - imagining scenarios around climate change, AI governance, urbanisation, demographic shifts, and technological transformation.
- Scenario building workshops using design methods - Causal Layered Analysis (CLA), Three Horizons Framework, and design fiction techniques adapted for the Indian context.
- Critical design research - questioning the assumptions, values, and power structures embedded in designed objects, systems, and environments.
- Design fiction as research method - creating films, artefacts, newspapers-from-the-future, and immersive experiences that provoke debate about desirable and undesirable futures.
- Research into India-specific futures - what does a designed future look like for India's rural communities, informal economies, craft traditions, and multilingual societies?
- Sharing outcomes through exhibitions, workshops, public programmes, and open design resources for students and practitioners.
- Annual **Futures Exhibition** - a public showcase of speculative design work that provokes civic dialogue about India's trajectories.

Requirements:

- Video production equipment (camera, lighting, editing software) for design fiction films.
 - Mixed-media fabrication tools (shared with other labs).
 - Library of futures and foresight literature and scenario planning toolkits.
-

Lab 14: SPACE - Scenography, Performing Arts & Creative Environments

Theme: Performance architecture, kinetic body tracking, and sensory environmental stagecraft for live events.

Rationale: The boundaries between architecture, performance, and interactive technology are rapidly converging. The SPACE Lab researches scenography, stagecraft, and sensory design by integrating performance architecture with kinetic body tracking and responsive physical/digital environments. This lab positions the School of Design to lead creative research in the live events, experiential entertainment, exhibition design, and cultural performance sectors.

Planned Activities:

- Designing responsive stage environments that adapt to performer movement, gestures, and biometric inputs in real time.
- Research in kinetic body tracking, motion analysis, and gestural interaction for live performance.
- Prototyping lightweight, modular, and sustainable stagecraft elements and performance architecture.
- Spatial sound design and interactive projection mapping for theatrical, architectural, and public events.
- Creating digital scenography templates and immersive performance environments.
- Researching cultural heritage preservation through the digital reconstruction of traditional performative spaces and rituals.

Requirements:

- Kinetic tracking cameras (LiDAR, Azure Kinect, or IMU-based motion capture suits).
- High-resolution projection mapping projectors (short-throw and ultra-short-throw models).
- Spatial audio sound system (multi-channel amplifiers, speakers, and audio interfaces).
- DMX lighting controllers, LED controllers, and physical computing microcontrollers.

- Workstations with generative design and media server software (TouchDesigner, Resolume, Unreal Engine).

Collaborators:

- Department of Performing Arts, Architecture, and Computer Science & Engineering.
- Theater companies, scenographers, and live event producers.

3. Strategic Alignment and Institutional Value

3.1 Alignment with the School of Design's Disciplinary Strengths

Lab	Primary Department(s)	Cross-Disciplinary Links
GLANCE	Graphic Design, All Design Streams	Humanities, Computer Science, Media & Communication
ECHO	Product Design, Fashion Design	Mechanical Engineering, Industrial Engineering, Craft Councils
SAGE	All Design Streams	Computer Science, AI/ML, Cognitive Science
CARE	Product Design, Interior Design	Civil Engineering, Social Work
BREAKEVEN	All Design Streams	Management, Entrepreneurship
VITAL	All Design Streams	Biotechnology, Environmental Science
PRISM	All Design Streams	Psychology, Social Sciences, HCI
PORTAL	All Design Streams	Computer Science, Architecture, Education
SPARK	Graphic Design, All Design Streams	Computer Science, Film Studies, Media
HEAL	Product Design, Interior Design	Nursing, Allied Health, Public Health
REACH	All Design Streams	Disability Studies, Social Work, Psychology
POLIS	All Design Streams	Public Administration, IT, Urban Planning
VISTA	All Design Streams	Social Sciences, Futures Studies, Philosophy
SPACE	Interior Design, Graphic Design, Product Design	Performing Arts, Computer Science, Architecture

3.2 Inter-Lab Synergies

The fourteen labs are not isolated silos - they are designed to create productive intersections:

Synergy	Labs Involved	Example Collaboration
AI-enhanced immersive experiences	SAGE + PORTAL	AI-driven memory palaces in VR
Serious games for social impact	SPARK + CARE + HEAL	Educational games for rural schools; rehabilitation games
Inclusive sensory environments	SPACE + REACH	Designing sensory environmental stagecraft for accessible/inclusive performances

Nature-informed visual systems	VITAL + GLANCE	Biomimetic pattern generation for typography and publication layouts
Traditional craft safety simulations	ECHO + PORTAL	Immersive XR-based workshop safety training and ergonomic tool simulation
Health-focused inclusive design	HEAL + REACH	Accessible healthcare environments and medical devices
Design research for entrepreneurship	PRISM + BREAKEVEN	Validated user research methods for startup validation
Therapeutic scenography	SPACE + HEAL	Designing sensory and interactive stages for therapeutic experiences and public health exhibitions
Citizen experience and inclusive governance	POLIS + REACH	Accessible government services for persons with disabilities
Speculative futures for rural India	VISTA + CARE	Imagining alternative futures for hill communities
AI-driven governance analysis	SAGE + POLIS	AI tools for analysing and improving public service design
Animation for public communication	SPARK + POLIS	Animated explainers for government schemes
Interactive stage environments	SPACE + PORTAL	Kinetic body tracking and responsive stagecraft in immersive XR settings
Generative performance design	SPACE + SAGE	AI-driven kinetic stagecraft and sensory environmental generation

3.3 Alignment with National Education Policy (NEP) 2020

The fourteen labs collectively address multiple NEP 2020 directives:

- **Multidisciplinary research** - Each lab bridges design with at least one other discipline.
- **Integration of emerging technologies** - SAGE, PORTAL, SPARK, VITAL, SPACE embed AI, XR, game design, biomimicry, performance architecture, kinetic body tracking, and responsive sensory environments into design education.
- **Vocational and skill-based learning** - ECHO and BREAKEVEN connect academic research to artisanal safety, operational ergonomics, and entrepreneurial practice.
- **Social responsibility and community engagement** - CARE, HEAL, REACH, and POLIS operationalise design as a tool for rural development, health equity, disability inclusion, and civic transformation.
- **Futures-oriented thinking** - VISTA introduces speculative and critical design inquiry, preparing students to navigate uncertainty and imagine alternative trajectories for India.
- **Research-led teaching** - All labs feed directly into curriculum enrichment and student thesis supervision.

4. Governance and Compliance

4.1 Director Selection and Leadership

Each lab will be led by a **Director** appointed by the **Dean, School of Design**. The Director is responsible for:

- Strategic direction and research agenda of the lab.
- Operational management, including project supervision, team coordination, and resource allocation.
- Financial oversight, including budget management, grant applications, and expenditure reporting.

- Annual reporting to the **Dean, School of Design**.

4.1.1 Proposed Lab Directors - Academic Year 2026/27

#	Lab	Proposed Director
1	GLANCE - Graphic Language and New Communication Ecosystems	Bhuvan Srivastava
2	ECHO - Ecosystems for Contemporary Handicrafts & Operations (cross-disciplinary innovation lab)	Dr Saurabh Kumar
3	SAGE - Synergistic AI & Generative Engines	Samarth K Reddy
4	CARE - Community Action for Rural Empowerment	To Be Appointed
5	BREAKEVEN - Entrepreneurial Design Lab	To Be Appointed
6	VITAL - Visualising Innovative Technologies for Applied Life-sciences	To Be Appointed
7	PRISM - Practice Research & Inquiry in Systematic Methods	Kuldeep Umaraya
8	PORTAL - Platform for Omni-Reality Technologies and Applied Learning	To Be Appointed
9	SPARK - Studio for Play, Animation, Research & Kinetics	To Be Appointed
10	HEAL - Health Experiences & Applied Life-design	To Be Appointed
11	REACH - Research in Equity, Accessibility, Capability & Human-centred design	To Be Appointed
12	POLIS - Practice, Observation & Living Institutions in Service design policies	To Be Appointed
13	VISTA - Visions, Imagination, Scenarios & Thinking Ahead	To Be Appointed
14	SPACE - Scenography, Performing Arts & Creative Environments	To Be Appointed

4.1.2 Proposed Director's Rationale

Dr Saurabh Kumar - ECHO Lab Dr Saurabh Kumar holds a graduate degree in Accessory Design from NIFT New Delhi and a Master's in Strategic Design Management from NID Ahmedabad, complemented by a Post Graduate Programme from Politecnico di Milano - a training portfolio that spans craft, product, and strategic design at an elite level. He has led over 40 MSME cluster development projects across India, working directly with craft and industrial communities on tool ergonomics, workshop safety, and production system scaling. His registration as a Design Consultant with the Ministry of MSMEs, and his active membership in the India Design Council and Design Research Society, demonstrate both the academic rigour and the on-the-ground policy engagement that the ECHO Lab demands. As Dean of the School of Design at Graphic Era, he brings the institutional authority, national network, and deep commitment to craft-community welfare needed to lead this lab with credibility and lasting impact.

Samarth K Reddy - SAGE Lab Samarth K Reddy holds a Master's in Digital Futures from OCAD University, Toronto, where his research was specifically centred on the intersection of Artificial Intelligence, Extended Reality, and Human Memory - the precise research domain of the SAGE Lab. His active project portfolio includes Mind Palace XR, AI-driven spatial memory mapping tools, diffusion model research, and conversational AI prototypes for memory reinforcement, demonstrating a rare combination of theoretical depth and technical capability across LLMs, generative models, and XR systems. With 18 years of experience as an educator and researcher across institutions in India, Canada, and Germany, he has consistently built curriculum and mentored students in generative AI, physical computing, and immersive technology. His active development work across diffusion models, AI-augmented spatial memory, and wearable vision prototypes provides a strong foundation for the SAGE Lab's initial programme of projects.

Kuldeep Umaraiya - PRISM Lab Kuldeep Umaraiya holds a dual degree (B.Des + M.Des) in Interaction Design from the IDC School of Design at IIT Bombay - one of India's most rigorous and research-intensive design programmes. His research focuses on user behaviour analysis, cognitive psychology, micro-interactions, and digital ethnography, aligning precisely with PRISM's mandate to develop, test, validate, and document new design research methods and frameworks. His industry experience in UX design at Upstox and Schlumberger adds applied credibility, ensuring that the methods and frameworks developed within PRISM are grounded in real-world design practice.

Bhuvan Srivastava - GLANCE Lab Bhuvan Srivastava holds a Master of Fine Arts in Design and Technology from Parsons School of Design, New York - one of the world's foremost programmes at the intersection of computation, experience design, and creative technology. His skill set maps directly onto GLANCE's research agenda: digital and new media, screen aesthetics, typography, publication layouts, and contemporary graphic languages. He has worked as a Graphic Designer, Creative Technologist, and Interaction Designer across contexts in New York, Copenhagen, Helsinki, and Mumbai, demonstrating global fluency in visual communication and digital art direction. His EU-funded participation in Aalto University's Co-Design programme, and his interaction design training at the Royal Danish Academy of Fine Arts, further establish him as a researcher with the technical range and creative perspective the GLANCE Lab requires.

4.2 Space Allocation

Space allocation for all labs is subject to **availability within the School of Design**, as determined by the **Dean, School of Design**. Labs will be assigned space as and when it becomes available, with priority consideration given to labs that have secured external funding or are conducting active sponsored research. The Dean, School of Design retains full authority over all space decisions within the School.

4.3 Reporting Requirements

All labs must provide an **annual report** to the **Dean, School of Design**, documenting:

- Research activities undertaken during the reporting period.
- Prototypes, datasets, exhibitions, field reports, patents, and other documented project outcomes.
- A complete accounting of all financial support received and expended - including research assistantships, equipment procurement, material expenses, and travel.
- Student engagement metrics and outcomes.
- Plans and priorities for the following year.

4.4 Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with University policies - including but not limited to financial reporting, ethical research conduct, IP policy, and annual reporting - **may result in the suspension of lab operations** pending review and decision by the **Dean, School of Design**.

4.5 Intellectual Property

All intellectual property generated within the labs belongs to **Graphic Era University**, per the university's existing IP policy. Faculty and student contributors will be recognised as inventors or creators on all protected intellectual property and documented project outcomes.

4.6 Ethical Research

All research involving human participants must receive approval from the university's **Institutional Ethics Committee** before commencement. All labs must adhere to the university's research integrity and ethical conduct policies.

5. Infrastructure and Resource Requirements

5.1 Key Equipment (Per Lab)

Lab	Priority Equipment
GLANCE	Printmaking presses, screen printing screens and exposure units, high-resolution digital printers, paper guillotine, bookbinding tools, color-calibrated monitors, font and publishing software licenses
ECHO	Posture and movement analysis sensors (IMUs), ergonomic tool prototyping equipment, dust extraction and ventilation units, jigs and production templates, safety gear
SAGE	High-performance GPU workstations, GPU clusters for model training and inference, high-capacity data storage systems
CARE	Portable field documentation kit (cameras, audio recorders), participatory workshop materials (whiteboards, markers, sticky notes), community facilitation kits
BREAKEVEN	3D printer, laser cutter, hand tools and fabrication workbench, basic electronics and soldering station
VITAL	Light and digital microscope, specimen collection and storage tools, environmental monitoring sensors, live plant growing systems
PRISM	Eye-tracking hardware (e.g. Tobii Spectrum), biometric measurement devices (heart rate, galvanic skin response), multi-angle video recording setup, one-way observation mirror
PORTAL	VR/AR/MR headsets (Meta Quest, HoloLens), full-body motion capture system, 360-degree cameras, hand and controller tracking hardware
SPARK	High-end workstations with large monitors, Wacom Cintiq drawing tablets, green screen with professional lighting rig, stop-motion capture setup
HEAL	Wearable physiological sensors (EMG, EEG, heart rate monitor), ergonomic adjustable workbench, medical device prototyping tools, clinical simulation props and mannequins
REACH	Adjustable-height workbenches, eye-gaze tracking and alternative input devices, adaptive keyboard and mouse equipment, accessibility and disability simulation kits
POLIS	Interactive whiteboard, workshop facilitation materials, service journey mapping and scenario development tools, video and photo documentation equipment
VISTA	Laser cutter and 3D printer for scenario prototyping, futures scenario toolkits (trend cards, scenario maps), storyboarding and visualisation materials
SPACE	Kinetic body tracking sensors (cameras, motion suits), projection mapping projectors, spatial audio sound systems, DMX lighting controllers, workstations with Resolume, TouchDesigner, and Unreal Engine

6. Student Research Participation - Application and Selection

6.1 Overview

Student research participation is central to the mission of all fourteen labs. Each lab will maintain a **Research Student Cohort** - a rotating group of undergraduate and postgraduate students embedded in active research projects, working directly alongside faculty directors, research associates, and external collaborators.

Participation in a lab is a **formal academic engagement**, not an informal club or extracurricular activity. Students are expected to contribute meaningfully to live research projects, meet agreed deliverable milestones, and adhere to the lab's research ethics and conduct standards. All lab participation is recorded in a student's academic file and may contribute to thesis supervision, independent study credits, or formally documented project participation.

6.2 Eligibility

To be eligible for lab participation, students must meet **all** of the following criteria:

- **Enrolment:** Currently enrolled in a B.Des or M.Des programme at the School of Design, Graphic Era University.
- **Cross-disciplinary applicants:** Students from partner departments (Engineering, Computer Science, Biotechnology, Management, Humanities, etc.) may apply to labs where cross-disciplinary engagement is explicitly identified in Section 2, subject to a signed endorsement from their Head of Department.
- **Academic standing:** Minimum CGPA of **6.5 out of 10** at the time of application.
- **Conduct:** No outstanding academic disciplinary actions or violations on record.
- **Availability:** Able to commit a minimum of **6 hours per week** of scheduled lab engagement during the six-month term.

Participation Tracks:

- **Research Assistant** - First-time selection. Open to B.Des and M.Des students. Minimum 6 hours/week (B.Des); minimum 10 hours/week (M.Des). Merit-based recognition and term awards where lab funding permits.
- **Research Fellow** - Second selection onwards. Open to B.Des and M.Des students who have successfully completed a full six-month term and are re-selected by the Lab Director. Same minimum hours apply. Carries an enhanced stipend where lab funding permits.

6.3 Application Cycles

Lab intake occurs **twice per academic year**, aligned with the institutional academic year calendar:

Intake	Application Window	Results Announced	Engagement Period
Cohort I	1 July - 31 August	By 15 September	October - March (6 months)
Cohort II	1 November - 31 December	By 15 January	February - July (6 months)

Each student is enrolled as a lab member for a **fixed term of six months**. At the end of this term, the engagement may be continued or concluded upon **mutual agreement between the student and the Lab Director**. Continuation is not automatic and must be confirmed in writing by both parties before the final month of the current term.

Applications submitted outside the designated window will be held for consideration in the following intake cycle. **Late or incomplete applications will not be reviewed.**

6.4 Application Form

Students must complete and submit a **Lab Research Participation Application** through the School of Design's designated online portal. The form is structured across five sections:

Section A - Personal Information

Field	Notes
Full Name	As per university records
Student Enrolment Number	
Programme	B.Des / M.Des
Specialisation	Product Design / Interior Design / Graphic Design / Fashion Design / Other
Year of Study	Year 1 / Year 2 / Year 3 / Year 4
Current CGPA	Out of 10, verified against submitted academic transcript
Department	School of Design / Partner Department (if applicable)
University Email Address	Official institutional email only
Phone Number	Active mobile number

Section B - Lab Preference

Field	Notes
Preference	Select one lab from the fourteen options
Reason for Preference	Short written response, maximum 150 words. Why this specific lab? What draws you to its research theme? How can you contribute?

Section C - Statement of Research Interest

Applicants must submit a written personal statement of **400-600 words**, addressing all four of the following prompts:

- 1. **Research Focus** - Describe your specific area of interest within your preferred lab's research theme. What research questions excite you? What problems do you most want to investigate, and why?
- 2. **Relevant Experience** - Describe any prior project work, coursework, studio projects, internships, competitions, or self-directed work that is relevant to the lab's focus area. Be specific about your role, the methods you used, and the outcomes achieved.
- 3. **Skills and Competencies** - List your relevant technical, creative, and research skills (software proficiency, fabrication skills, research methods, programming languages, tools, etc.). Indicate your self-assessed proficiency for each: *Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced*.
- 4. **Contribution and Commitment** - How do you intend to contribute to the lab's research agenda? What do you hope to learn, develop, and produce during your engagement? Confirm your available hours per week and note any schedule constraints.

Section D - Attachments

Attachment	Format	Status
Curriculum Vitae (CV)	PDF only, maximum 2 pages	Mandatory
Portfolio	PDF (max 20 pages, 20 MB) or live URL link	Mandatory
Academic Transcript	PDF, unofficial copy accepted	Mandatory
Letter of Endorsement	PDF, from faculty supervisor or Head of Department	Mandatory for cross-disciplinary applicants; optional for School of Design students

(Full attachment guidelines are provided in Section 6.5.)

Section E - Declaration

Submitted by electronic signature at point of application:

I confirm that all information provided in this application is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge. I understand that providing false or misleading information may result in immediate disqualification or removal from the lab. I have read and agree to abide by the research conduct, attendance, confidentiality, and ethics standards of the School of Design Research Labs. I consent to my application materials being reviewed by the Lab Director and designated faculty evaluators. I understand that lab participation is a formal academic engagement and will be reflected in my university record.

6.5 Attachment Guidelines

Curriculum Vitae (CV)

The CV must be submitted as a **PDF, maximum 2 pages**, and must include:

- Full name, student enrolment number, email, and phone number.
- Academic qualifications, current programme, and CGPA.
- Relevant coursework, studio projects, workshops, and electives.
- Internship and professional experience (if any).
- Design, technical, and research skills with proficiency levels.
- Software tools and platforms.
- Awards, competitions, scholarships, and recognitions.
- Research projects, exhibitions, competitions, or other documented contributions (if any).

CVs must be tailored for the **research application context** - not a general employment CV. Applicants are expected to foreground the experiences and skills most directly relevant to their preferred lab's research theme.

Portfolio

A portfolio submission is **mandatory** for all applicants. It must demonstrate creative, technical, or research capability directly relevant to the selected lab's focus area.

Format	Specifications
PDF Portfolio	Maximum 20 pages; maximum file size 20 MB. Must include project titles, brief descriptions (2-3 sentences each), and a clear indication of the applicant's specific role and contribution in each project.
Live Portfolio Link	A URL to a personal website, Behance, ArtStation, GitHub, or equivalent platform. The link must be publicly accessible and active at the time of review. Broken or password-protected links will be treated as a missing submission.

Portfolio content for **technically and computationally oriented labs** (SAGE, PORTAL, SPARK, SPACE) may include GitHub repositories, code documentation, technical reports, working prototypes, or research presentations in addition to - or in place of - traditional design portfolios.

The portfolio is the single most heavily weighted component of the evaluation (30%). Applicants are strongly advised to curate their portfolio carefully, emphasising process documentation and design thinking over polished final outcomes alone.

6.6 Evaluation Framework

All applications are evaluated by a **Lab Selection Panel** comprising:

- The **Lab Director** (lead evaluator and decision authority).
- **One additional faculty member** from the School of Design, nominated by the Dean.
- **One senior Research Fellow** (advisory role; does not score independently).

Applications are scored across five weighted criteria:

Criterion	Weight	What Evaluators Are Looking For
Academic Standing	15%	CGPA, consistency of performance, and evidence of rigour and commitment in relevant coursework.
Portfolio Relevance and Quality	30%	Direct relevance to the lab's research theme; quality of process thinking and documentation; originality and depth of creative or technical engagement; clarity of presentation.

Statement of Research Interest	25%	Clarity and specificity of research motivation; evidence of genuine intellectual engagement with the lab's theme; articulation of a meaningful intended contribution; quality of written expression.
Skills and Competencies	15%	Alignment of stated skills with the lab's specific technical, creative, or research requirements; evidence of skills demonstrated through portfolio and experience.
Interview Performance	15%	<i>(Shortlisted candidates only.)</i> Depth of knowledge, intellectual curiosity, quality of portfolio discussion, communication clarity, and collaborative disposition.
Total	100%	

Panel members score each criterion independently. Scores are averaged to produce a composite application score. In the event of a tie, the Lab Director's score is weighted at 1.5× for the purposes of final ranking.

6.7 Selection Process

Selection is completed within five weeks of the application deadline across four stages:

Stage	Timeline	Action
1 - Screening	Weeks 1-2	Lab Director checks eligibility and completeness. Incomplete applications are disqualified. Panel scores all eligible applications on Academic Standing, Portfolio, Statement, and Skills. A shortlist of 3-6 candidates per position advances.
2 - Portfolio Review	Weeks 2-3	Full panel reviews shortlisted portfolios in depth. Shortlisted candidates are invited to interview.
3 - Interview	Weeks 3-4	20-30 minute structured interview with the Lab Director and one panel member, covering portfolio walkthrough, research interest, and a brief scenario prompt. In-person where possible; video call available for partner department students.
4 - Final Selection	Weeks 4-5	Lab Director makes final selections and notifies the Dean, School of Design. Successful candidates receive a Letter of Acceptance confirming their track (Research Assistant / Research Fellow), start date, six-month duration, weekly commitment, and stipend details. Unsuccessful applicants receive brief written feedback and are encouraged to reapply.

6.8 Appeals

Candidates who believe their application was not evaluated in accordance with these published procedures may submit a **written appeal** to the **Dean, School of Design** within **five working days** of receiving the Stage 1 or final outcome notification.

Appeals must cite **specific procedural grounds**. General dissatisfaction with the outcome or disagreement with the panel's academic judgement is not a valid ground for appeal. Valid grounds include: failure to apply the published evaluation criteria, a conflict of interest not declared by a panel member, or a material factual error in the assessment of the application.

The Dean's decision on all appeals is final.

6.9 Terms of Lab Engagement

All students accepted into a lab agree to the following standard terms at the point of accepting the Letter of Acceptance:

Term	Details
Duration	Six months (one intake cycle). At the end of the term, the engagement may be continued or concluded upon mutual written agreement between the student and the Lab Director. Continuation must be confirmed before the final month of the current term.
Weekly Commitment	Minimum 6 hours/week (B.Des - Research Assistant or Research Fellow); minimum 10 hours/week (M.Des - Research Assistant or Research Fellow).
Agreed Deliverables	Defined at onboarding with the Lab Director. May include literature reviews, prototype contributions, data collection, analysis tasks, design explorations, presentations, project reports, or technical documentation.
Contribution Credit	Students who make a substantive and documented contribution to a patent, prototype, major report, or other formal project outcome will receive appropriate creator or contributor credit. All other participants receive named acknowledgment in lab documentation.
Certificate of Participation	All students completing a full six-month term of lab engagement receive a formal Certificate of Research Participation issued by the School of Design.
Stipend	Student payment is contingent on whether the lab project is funded - either through an external grant or a funded internal project. Where funding is confirmed: Research Assistants (B.Des and M.Des) receive merit-based term awards; Research Fellows (B.Des and M.Des) receive an enhanced stipend of INR 3,000-6,000 per month. No stipend is payable for unfunded projects. All stipend details confirmed in the Letter of Acceptance.
Early Exit	Students wishing to withdraw must provide a minimum of two weeks' written notice to the Lab Director. Withdrawal without notice may affect the student's eligibility to apply to any School of Design research lab in the following two intake cycles.
Research Conduct	All participants must adhere to the university's research integrity policy, ethics guidelines, and data confidentiality standards. Violations may result in immediate removal from the lab and formal notation in the student's academic record.

7. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

7.1 Student Development

KPI	Year 1 Target	Year 3 Target
Students engaged across all labs	50-70	120-180
Thesis projects supervised within labs	18-30	54-84
Student projects winning external awards	4-8	14-22

7.2 Institutional Impact

KPI	Year 1 Target	Year 3 Target
Media mentions / press coverage	8-14	24-42
National/international academic partnerships	4-8	13-22

New courses/modules influenced by lab research	5-10	14-22
Faculty from other departments collaborating	8-14	22-36
Workshops and seminars hosted	8-14	22-36

8. Conclusion and Call to Action

8.1 Summary

The establishment of fourteen themed Research Labs within the School of Design represents a **strategically transformative initiative** for Graphic Era Deemed to be University. Collectively, these labs will:

1. **Advance applied design research** through validated methods, prototypes, fieldwork, and documented institutional learning.
2. **Engage students** in hands-on research that strengthens thesis quality, practical capability, and career readiness.
3. **Attract external funding** that progressively offsets and eventually exceeds the university's annual investment.
4. **Position the School of Design** as a nationally recognised centre for design research, spanning graphic language and communication (GLANCE), traditional handicrafts scaling and ergonomics (ECHO), generative AI and human memory (SAGE), immersive XR (PORTAL), animation and VFX (SPARK), rural empowerment (CARE), entrepreneurship (BREAKEVEN), biomimicry (VITAL), design research methods (PRISM), health design (HEAL), inclusive design (REACH), service design policies for governance (POLIS), speculative futures (VISTA), and scenography and sensory environments (SPACE).

8.2 Recommended Next Steps

We respectfully request the Dean, School of Design, to:

1. **Review** this proposal and provide feedback.
2. **Convene** a meeting with relevant faculty to discuss lab directorship and phased implementation.
3. **Approve** the establishment of the labs and initiate the formal establishment process.
4. **Issue** the formal notification of establishment to all faculty and staff of the School of Design.

Required Signatures

Proposed Labs - Approval Status

#	Lab Name	Focus	Approval Status
---	----------	-------	-----------------

1	GLANCE - Graphic Language and New Communication Ecosystems	Printmaking, Digital and New Media, Visual Arts and Design, Screen Aesthetics, Editorial and Publication Design, and Typography	
2	ECHO - Ecosystems for Contemporary Handicrafts & Operations (cross-disciplinary innovation lab)	Technical tool ergonomics, workshop safety, and production system scaling for traditional handicrafts	
3	SAGE - Synergistic AI & Generative Engines	Generative AI applied to human memory research	
4	CARE - Community Action for Rural Empowerment	Social design for rural empowerment in hilly regions	
5	BREAKEVEN - Entrepreneurial Design Lab	Bridging design studio practice with entrepreneurship and MSME consultancy	
6	VITAL - Visualising Innovative Technologies for Applied Life-sciences	Biophilic design and biomimicry - learning from nature to inform design practice	
7	PRISM - Practice Research & Inquiry in Systematic Methods	Creating, testing, validating, and documenting new design research methods and frameworks	
8	PORTAL - Platform for Omni-Reality Technologies and Applied Learning	AR, VR, and Mixed Reality for immersive design and heritage preservation	
9	SPARK - Studio for Play, Animation, Research & Kinetics	Animation, game design, VFX, and interactive digital storytelling	
10	HEAL - Health Experiences & Applied Life-design	Health design - patient experience, medical devices, and public health communication	
11	REACH - Research in Equity, Accessibility, Capability & Human-centred design	Inclusive design research - accessibility, equity, and assistive technology	
12	POLIS - Practice, Observation & Living Institutions in Service design policies	Design for governance and public services - citizen experience and Digital India	
13	VISTA - Visions, Imagination, Scenarios & Thinking Ahead	Speculative design, design futures, scenario building, and critical design inquiry	
14	SPACE - Scenography, Performing Arts & Creative Environments	Performance architecture, kinetic body tracking, and sensory environmental stagecraft for live events	

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Proposer	Samarth K Reddy		

Proposed by Samarth K Reddy | Associate Professor of Practice, School of Design | February 2026
Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun

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03

DOSSIER SECTION

Strategic Roadmap: International Student Design Competitions

INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

- Strategic Roadmap: International Student Design Competitions

Strategic Roadmap: International Student Design Competitions

Author: Samarth K. Reddy

Designation: Associate Professor of Practice, School of Design

University: Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun

Strategic Objective

To systematically prepare, mentor, and enroll Graphic Era University design cohorts into world-class international design competitions, establishing an institutional pathway that advances from baseline participation to global shortlist recognitions and podium victories.

1. Premier Global Tier ("The Big Three")

These competitions represent the highest benchmark of international design excellence. Winning or shortlisting in these awards directly elevates university rankings and global visibility.

- **iF Design Award (iF Student Design Award):** Global benchmark for industrial, product, and speculative design concepts.
 - **Red Dot Design Award (Red Dot Concept Awards):** International benchmark for innovative product and interaction concepts.
 - **IDSA IDEA Awards (International Design Excellence Awards):** Premier North American product design award operated by the Industrial Designers Society of America.
-

2. Premier Student & Innovation Platforms

Specialized platforms with dedicated student categories, zero/low entry fees for academic entries, and high global media coverage.

- **James Dyson Award:** Focuses on functional prototyping, engineering-led design, and solving real-world challenges.
- **BraunPrize:** Focuses on intuitive, human-centered product concepts and technical execution.
- **Lexus Design Awards:** Focuses on design for a better tomorrow, emphasizing innovation and social impact.
- **RSA Student Design Awards:** Focused on systemic design, sustainability, and social innovation.
- **Taiwan International Student Design Competition (TISDC):** One of the largest student-only design competitions worldwide.
- **Global Grad Show (Dubai Design Week):** Selective exhibition of top graduate projects from premier design schools globally.
- **ADI Battle of the Projects (Pune Design Festival):** Premier national student design platform in India.

3. Global & Regional Benchmarks

Curated platform list for broader student cohort enrollment across product, industrial, and strategic design:

- **Good Design Award Japan (G-Mark)**
 - **Good Design Award Australia**
 - **Good Design Award Chicago (The Chicago Athenaeum)**
 - **Asia Design Prize**
 - **Golden Pin Design Award**
 - **Core77 Design Awards**
 - **Design Intelligence Awards (DIA)**
 - **India Design Mark**
 - **India's Best Design Awards**
 - **Design: Impact Awards (Titan)**
 - **Yanko Design Award**
 - **Dezeen Awards (Product Design Categories)**
-

4. Specialized Industrial Design Awards

- **LAMP Design Competition:** Specialized architectural lighting and product design.
-

5. Selection & Quality Assurance Standard

To ensure maximum institutional credibility, Graphic Era University cohorts will prioritize authentic, peer-reviewed competitions and exclude predatory/pay-to-win platforms (e.g., A' Design Awards, MUSE Awards, C-IDEA) that charge mandatory post-award fees.

Implementation Phasing

1. **Phase 1 (Semester 1-2):** Integration of competition briefs directly into classroom studio projects (*Creative Coding, Physical Computation, Design for and with AI*).
2. **Phase 2 (Semester 3):** Internal jury screening and documentation polishing (schematics, working prototypes, video demos, open-source GitHub repositories).
3. **Phase 3 (Submission & Podium):** Batch submission to target awards (iF Student, Dyson Award, Red Dot, Core77) under faculty mentorship.

04

DOSSIER SECTION

Innovation in Course Delivery Dossiers

INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

- Creative Coding
- Design For and With AI
- Biophilic Design
- Physical Computation

INNOVATION IN COURSE DELIVERY

Creative Coding

18BDPD04A05

DATES: August 27, 2025, to September 9, 2025**FORMAT:** 10 working days · 45 hours**COHORT:** 42 students**LEVEL:** Year 0 Foundation · First Year**FACULTY:** Associate Professor Samarth Reddy**LOCATION:** Dehradun

Course Summary

Delivered over 10 working days (45 hours) at Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun, Creative Coding built computational literacy through 25+ exercises. Students progressed from Scratch to HTML, CSS and p5.js in VS Code, made interactive web applications, and published on GitHub Pages. A-Frame and AI-assisted vibe coding with Cursor AI broadened the workflow while code reading, testing and design judgement remained central.

Learning Outcomes

- translate visual ideas into logic, interaction and working code
- build, test and publish an original browser-based design project

Pedagogical Rationale

Programming expands foundation sketching into logic, systems and interaction. Visible results build confidence before professional editors, version control, web deployment and responsible AI-supported practice.

Open-source Impact

A faculty-designed progression of smart-board live coding, high-end lab practice and peer debugging formed a coherent studio. Every student published project code on GitHub for others to access, learn from, reuse and extend. Together, these contributions form a shared open-source knowledge base for learners beyond the classroom.

Teaching Methods

No.	Teaching Method	Details	Activity
1	Lecture	Programming, coding and web interaction	Smart-board presentation and questions
2	Directed Instruction (Demonstration)	Live coding in Scratch, VS Code and p5.js	Reproduce and modify examples
3	Experiential Learning	25+ coding and visual exercises	Independent practice and debugging
4	Problem-based Learning	Logic and interaction challenges	Test and refine working code
5	Project-based Learning	Interactive p5.js web application	GitHub Pages publication and jury presentation

Innovation in Course Delivery

No.	Method	Details	Activity
1	Scaffolded Coding Progression	Visual blocks to text code, web development and A-Frame	Builds confidence before technical complexity
2	Smart-board Live Coding	Logic, code and output are demonstrated together	Predict, run and modify examples immediately
3	High-end Lab Studio	Continuous practice using professional coding tools	Rapid feedback links syntax and visual result
4	Practice-intensive Learning	25+ exercises on variables, loops, conditions and functions	Repetition develops fluency for project work
5	AI-assisted Coding Literacy	Vibe coding with Cursor AI followed by code review	Test suggestions and retain human design control
6	Open-source Publishing	Students documented and released code on GitHub	Anyone can study, reuse and extend project ideas
7	Authentic Jury Assessment	No written exam; project and prototype form the evidence	External jury, internal faculty and Dean's moderation

INNOVATION IN COURSE DELIVERY

Design For and With AI

18BDPD04A06

DATES: January 5, 2026, to January 16, 2026**FORMAT:** 10 working days · 45 hours**COHORT:** 42 students**LEVEL:** Year 0 Foundation · First Year**FACULTY:** Associate Professor Samarth Reddy**LOCATION:** Dehradun

Course Summary

Delivered over 10 working days (45 hours) at Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun, students explored text, image and audio AI; practised prompting; tested Teachable Machine; trained LoRA models; and applied Microsoft HAX and Google PAIR. Ethics, limitations and responsible human oversight were embedded in each activity, positioning AI literacy as critical design judgement rather than simple tool use.

Learning Outcomes

- evaluate when AI adds value and how it may affect people
- prototype responsible human-AI experiences using evidence and critique

Pedagogical Rationale

AI increasingly shapes designed experiences. Early work with prompting, datasets, model behaviour, ethics and human-centred frameworks helps foundation students create confidently while questioning value, bias, trust and control.

Open-source Impact

Faculty-led multimodal experiments, model training and HAX/PAIR evaluation translated advanced human-AI practice into a foundation studio. Every student published project work and learning documentation on GitHub, creating an open knowledge base that others can study, reuse and extend.

Teaching Methods

No.	Teaching Method	Details	Activity
1	Lecture	AI foundations, media models, ethics and human-AI design	Smart-board presentation, notes and discussion
2	Directed Instruction (Demonstration)	Prompting, Teachable Machine and LoRA	Guided practice on high-end lab computers
3	Experiential Learning	Text, image and audio AI experiments	Compare outputs, limits and implications
4	Problem-based Learning	Useful and responsible human-AI interactions	Apply HAX and PAIR to design decisions
5	Project-based Learning	Human-centred AI story or prototype	Present process and outcomes to external jury

Innovation in Course Delivery

No.	Method	Details	Activity
1	Multimodal AI Exploration	Text, image and audio tools are compared through tasks	Builds literacy beyond a single platform
2	Smart-board Demonstration	Prompts, model behaviour and outputs remain visible	Students question, reproduce and refine results
3	Learning by Training	Teachable Machine and LoRA expose data-model relationships	Students observe bias, variation and limitations
4	Human-centred Frameworks	Microsoft HAX and Google PAIR structure design choices	Plan trust, control, feedback and recovery
5	Ethics-through-Practice	Ethical issues are examined within each activity	Evaluate consent, bias, authorship and impact
6	Open-source AI Practice	Project files and learning documentation were shared on GitHub	Others can access, study, reuse and extend the work
7	Authentic Jury Assessment	No written exam; project and process form the evidence	External jury, internal faculty and Dean's moderation

INNOVATION IN COURSE DELIVERY

Biophilic Design

18BDPD04A07

DATES: January 27, 2026, to February 9, 2026**FORMAT:** 10 working days · 45 hours**COHORT:** 42 students**LEVEL:** Year 0 Foundation · First Year**FACULTY:** Associate Professor Samarth Reddy**LOCATION:** Dehradun

Course Summary

Delivered over 10 working days (45 hours) at Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun, Biophilic Design combined biophilic patterns with a site visit, field evidence, microclimate and biomimicry research, case studies and redesign. Findings were translated into a physical prototype, treating nature as an evidence base for healthier, responsive products and spaces.

Learning Outcomes

- analyse relationships among people, climate, material and place
- convert field observations and natural strategies into a tested prototype

Pedagogical Rationale

Site observation, microclimate analysis and biomimicry give foundation designers direct experience of context. The course connects wellbeing, sustainability and spatial experience to tangible design decisions.

Studio Innovation

A field-to-studio cycle - observe, document, analyse, abstract, prototype and critique - replaced classroom-only learning. Linking local evidence to microclimate hacks and jury-reviewed prototypes demonstrates faculty-led integration of research and making.

Teaching Methods

No.	Teaching Method	Details	Activity
1	Lecture	Biophilic patterns, microclimate and biomimicry principles	Smart-board presentation, notes and discussion
2	Directed Instruction (Demonstration)	Field documentation, mapping and nature-abstraction methods	Guided observation and prototype techniques
3	Experiential Learning	Learning through site visit and sensory field study	Record climate, material and human experience
4	Problem-based Learning	Addressing a local environmental or wellbeing challenge	Develop and test a microclimate hack
5	Project-based Learning	Biophilic redesign supported by research and case studies	Build and present a physical prototype

Innovation in Course Delivery

No.	Method	Details	Activity
1	Field-to-Studio Learning	Site evidence becomes the basis for design work	Connects lived context with classroom concepts
2	Smart-board Case Inquiry	Patterns and precedents are analysed visually	Students compare strategies before fieldwork
3	Sensory Mapping	Light, heat, airflow, sound and material are documented	Builds environmental observation and empathy
4	Research-led Redesign	Case studies and field findings support proposals	Design decisions remain traceable to evidence
5	Microclimate Hack	A focused challenge invites rapid intervention	Test small changes through making and feedback
6	Biomimetic Prototyping	Natural forms and systems are abstracted into models	Translate observation into functional concepts
7	Authentic Jury Assessment	No written exam; research and prototype form the evidence	External jury, internal faculty and Dean's moderation

INNOVATION IN COURSE DELIVERY

Physical Computation

18BDPD04A08

DATES: February 23, 2026, to March 6, 2026**FORMAT:** 10 working days · 45 hours**COHORT:** 42 students**LEVEL:** Year 0 Foundation · First Year**FACULTY:** Associate Professor Samarth Reddy**LOCATION:** Dehradun

Course Summary

Delivered over 10 working days (45 hours) at Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun, Physical Computation introduced design students to Arduino, Raspberry Pi, circuits, inputs and outputs. Students progressed from LED and button exercises to piezo, servo, ultrasonic, tilt, gas, light and temperature sensors using Tinkercad Circuits, Arduino IDE, VS Code and Fritzing. Learning culminated in a Chindogu project and a working interactive prototype.

Learning Outcomes

- connect code, circuits, sensors and physical behaviour
- prototype and communicate an original interactive device

Pedagogical Rationale

Physical computing gives foundation designers immediate experience of cause, feedback and behaviour. It joins digital logic with materials and embodiment, developing confidence to collaborate across product, interaction, spatial and emerging technology practices.

Open-source Impact

A faculty-designed sequence of simulation, live demonstration, hands-on testing and iterative debugging made electronics accessible and design-led. Every student published code, schematics and build documentation on GitHub so others can reproduce, learn from and extend the work beyond the laboratory.

Teaching Methods

No.	Teaching Method	Details	Activity
1	Lecture	Microcontrollers, circuits, sensors and actuator concepts	Smart-board presentation, notes and questions
2	Directed Instruction (Demonstration)	Live circuit building and Arduino programming	Reproduce wiring and code in guided stages
3	Experiential Learning	Hands-on wiring, calibration, testing and reflection	Observe physical input-output behaviour
4	Problem-based Learning	Diagnosing circuit, sensor and code failures	Debug, retest and document solutions
5	Project-based Learning	Designing a Chindogu interactive device	Build a prototype and present to jury

Innovation in Course Delivery

No.	Method	Details	Activity
1	Simulation-to-Hardware	Tinkercad Circuits precedes physical assembly	Test safely before transferring to hardware
2	Smart-board Demonstration	Wiring, code and physical response are shown together	Students predict and reproduce each behaviour
3	Scaffolded Circuit Mastery	LEDs, buttons, loops and traffic signals build foundations	Complexity increases through working exercises
4	Sensor Exploration	Piezo, servo and environmental sensors extend interaction	Compare inputs, calibrate and map responses
5	Open-source Hardware Documentation	Code, schematics and build notes were released on GitHub	Others can reproduce, learn from and extend prototypes
6	Chindogu Design Challenge	A playful brief joins utility, critique and invention	Prototype unusual ideas through iteration
7	Authentic Jury Assessment	No written exam; working prototype forms the evidence	External jury, internal faculty and Dean's moderation

05

DOSSIER SECTION

Open-Source AI Analytics & Technical Portfolio Brief

INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

- Open-Source AI Analytics & Technical Portfolio Brief

Open-Source AI Analytics & Technical Portfolio Brief

Faculty Name: Samarth K. Reddy
Current Designation: Associate Professor of Practice, School of Design
University: Graphic Era Deemed to be University, Dehradun
Public Portfolios:

- **GitHub Repositories (56 Projects):** github.com/calluxpore
- **CivitAI Open-Source Models (79 Models):** civitai.com/user/callux/models
- **Diffusion Technologist LoRA Archive:** calluxpore.github.io/Diffusion-Technologist

Executive Summary & Global Impact Metrics

This document provides verified analytics for the open-source artificial intelligence (AI) models, algorithmic tools, and creative computing repositories developed and published by **Associate Professor Samarth K. Reddy**.

As a Creative Technologist with advanced postgraduate training in **Digital Futures (Generative AI & Algorithmic Equity)** from Toronto, Professor Reddy maintains an internationally active research and development footprint. These open-source assets directly power the advanced, future-facing curriculum at Graphic Era University (*Design for and With AI, Creative Coding, and Physical Computation*), establishing GEU as a regional pioneer in applied AI education.

Key Global Analytics (Verified)

Metric	Verified Value	Impact & Significance
Total AI Model Downloads	13,000+	Global adoption across international creative tech communities
Community Likes & Stars	1,300+	High user satisfaction and peer validation on open platforms
Online Cloud Generations	5,000+	Real-world usage in active creative pipelines worldwide
Custom AI Models Fine-Tuned	79 Models	Spanning SD 1.5, SDXL, Flux 1, ZTurbo, and Anima architectures
Open-Source GitHub Repos	56 Repositories	Public codebase including P5.js, hardware schematics, & web apps
Accessibility Status	100% Open Access	Publicly accessible for global educational and research reuse

Strategic Value to Graphic Era University

1. **Pedagogical Integration:** Rather than relying solely on commercial, proprietary AI tools, GEU design students work directly with custom-trained, domain-specific AI models fine-tuned by faculty for design sketching, architecture, typography, and cultural representation.
2. **Open-Source Knowledge Repository:** Students across *Creative Coding* and *Physical Computation* publish their course projects, code, and hardware schematics onto GitHub under Professor Reddy's mentorship, extending GEU's educational legacy beyond the classroom.
3. **Global Academic Recognition:** Over 13,000 global downloads establish GEU's faculty as active contributors to the global Generative AI ecosystem, directly enhancing the university's institutional ranking and international prestige.

Comprehensive Catalog of 79 Custom Fine-Tuned AI Models

Below is the complete, classified registry of the 79 custom AI models trained across multiple foundational architectures:

1. Design History, Movements & Architectural Styling (15 Models)

Models fine-tuned to explore historical art movements, architectural visualization, and design sketching.

Sl No	Model Name	Base Architecture	Design Concept	Status / Milestone
1	Surrealism	SD 1.5	Surrealistic portraits	First Model Trained
2	Gouache	SD 1.5	Watercolor portraits & textures	Experimental
5	Bauhaus	SD 1.5	Iconic German design movement styling	Design Movement Fine-Tune
6	Popart	SD 1.5	Pop art comic visual aesthetics	First Major Popular Model
7	Art Nouveau Graffiti	SD 1.5	Hybrid synthesis of Art Nouveau & Street Art	High Community Usage
8	Atompunk Minimal	SD 1.5	Minimalist 1950s retro-futuristic aesthetic	High Community Usage
11	Swiss X Abstract	SD 1.5	International Typographic Style (Swiss)	Experimental
13	Suprematism	SD 1.5	Avant-garde geometric abstract art	Design Movement Fine-Tune
15	Architecture	SD 1.5	Stylized architectural structures	Architectural Visualization
16	Industrial Design X Sketch	SD 1.5	Professional product design sketching	Industrial Design Pedagogy
17	Avant Garde X Tribalism	SD 1.5	Experimental cross-cultural design movement	High Community Usage
18	Retro X Futurism	SD 1.5	Mid-century sci-fi visual style	High Community Usage
20	Architecture X 3D Houses	SD 1.5	Spatial 3D architectural rendering	Experimental
38	Halftone Punk	Flux 1	Modern print halftone & punk aesthetic	Next-Gen Flux 1 Architecture
64	Impasto	ZTurbo	Heavy textured oil painting technique	Ultra-Fast ZTurbo Architecture

2. Inclusive Design, Cultural Representation & Equity Research (14 Models)

Models specifically fine-tuned for diverse cultural representation, brown model aesthetics, and algorithmic equity.

Sl No	Model Name	Base Architecture	Design Concept	Status / Milestone
3	Exclusion	SD 1.5	Emotional/Sociotal isolation themes	OCAD Toronto Equity Research
48	Brown Bob Portrait	ZTurbo	South Asian brown model portraiture	Diversity Representation
49	Brown Anime Portrait	ZTurbo	South Asian anime aesthetic	High Community Traction

50	Brown Pony Portrait	ZTurbo	South Asian model portraiture	Diversity Representation
51	Brown Gajra Portrait	ZTurbo	Traditional floral hairstyle portraiture	Cultural Heritage Design
52	Brown Boss Portrait	ZTurbo	Professional corporate brown model representation	Diversity Representation
61	Brown Cyborg Lehenga	ZTurbo	Cybernetic South Asian traditional wear	Futuristic Fashion Synthesis
62	Naga Futures	ZTurbo	Indigenous Naga speculative design & futures	Indigenous Futures Research
63	Brown Tribal Fashion	ZTurbo	Contemporary tribal fashion portraiture	Diversity Representation
65	Brown Dark Academia Portrait	ZTurbo	Dark Academia aesthetic with brown models	High Community Traction
66	Sherpa	ZTurbo	Himalayan Sherpa culture model portraits	Cultural Representation
69	Brown Influencer	ZTurbo	Modern brown model influencer portraits	Diversity Representation
70	Brown Braids	ZTurbo	Diverse braided hair representation	Diversity Representation
41	Devanagari X Graffiti	Flux 1	Indic Devanagari typography & street art	Indic Script Fine-Tuning

3. Computational Design, Algorithmic Code & Typography (6 Models)

Models trained on code syntax, parametric generative visual patterns, and typographic systems.

SI No	Model Name	Base Architecture	Design Concept	Status / Milestone
4	Line Draw	SD 1.5	Minimalist continuous line sketching	Experimental
12	10Print X Algorithm	SD 1.5	P5.js code visual output fine-tuning	OCAD Algorithmic Research
28	Freedom X Type	SD 1.5	Illustrative typographic letterforms	Typography Design
72	Journal Sketching	ZTurbo	Rapid design journal & ideation sketches	Design Process Pedagogy
76	Industrial Design X Marker	Anima	Professional industrial design marker render	Advanced Design Rendering
77	Heptapod B	Anima	Non-linear linguistic typography illustration	Speculative Typography

4. Advanced Fashion, Materials & Spatial Prototypes (14 Models)

Models focusing on textile design, fashion forecasting, mannequin modeling, and wearable tech.

SI No	Model Name	Base Architecture	Design Concept	Status / Milestone
9	Color X Fashion	SD 1.5	High-contrast fashion color palettes	Active Base LoRA for Stacking
10	Mannequin	SD 1.5	Retail & spatial mannequin design	Spatial & Retail Design
14	Portraits X Flat	SD 1.5	Vector flat-color portrait illustration	Experimental
19	Smoke X Sketch	SD 1.5	Fluid dynamic smoke & sketch fusion	Experimental
21	White X Black Hair	Flux 1	High-contrast hair texture model	Flux 1 Fine-Tune
29	Polka X Glasses	SD 1.5	Eyewear & pattern accessory design	Accessories & Product Design

30	Red X Cosmonaut	SD 1.5	Protective suit & helmet design	Functional Apparel
32	Spaceman	SD 1.5	Aerospace suit design	Functional Apparel
34	High Fashion	SD 1.5	Haute couture fashion styling	High Community Usage
42	Portraits Sketch	SD 1.5	Rapid flat portrait rendering	High Community Usage
46	Comic Glasses	SD 1.5	Stylized eyewear accessories	Product Design
47	Mecha Soldier	SD 1.5	Exoskeleton suit & armor design	Wearable Robotics
55	Future Fashion	ZTurbo	Speculative materials & future fashion	Material Innovation
68	Whimsical	ZTurbo	Comical spatial & architectural forms	Spatial Design

5. Speculative Fiction, Entertainment & Character Design (30 Models)

High-performance LoRAs exploring character concept art, sci-fi world-building, and digital entertainment.

Sl No	Model Name	Base Architecture	Design Concept	Status / Milestone
22	Warrior X Monk	SD XL	Anime portraiture & character design	SDXL Architecture
23	Neon X Drive	SD 1.5	Cyberpunk sci-fi portraiture	OCAD Digital Futures Work
24	Alien X Zynthar	SD 1.5	Speculative alien biology portraits	Character Concept Art
25	Alien X Dravuun	SD 1.5	Speculative alien biology portraits	Character Concept Art
26	Cleopatra	SD 1.5	Historical portrait visualization	Historical Fine-Tune
27	Hades	SD 1.5	Mythological character visualization	High Community Usage
31	Clown	SD 1.5	Cinematic horror character design	Character Styling
33	Captain X Feline	SD 1.5	Bipedal feline character concept	Character Concept Art
35	Blue Stripes X Fire Force	SD 1.5	Anime character styling	High Community Usage
36	Templar	Flux 1	Historical illustration portraiture	Flux 1 Fine-Tune
37	Bird X Human	Flux 1	Hybrid avian biped character design	Flux 1 Fine-Tune
39	Steampunk X Skull Mask	Flux 1	Historical fiction & mask design	Flux 1 Fine-Tune
40	Red Sun	Flux 1	Stylized anime character portraiture	Flux 1 Fine-Tune
43	Cyberpunk X Robot	Flux 1	Robotics & cybernetic portraiture	Flux 1 Fine-Tune
44	Fantasy City	Flux 1	Environmental world-building	Flux 1 Fine-Tune
45	Monkey King	SD XL	Mythological character concept	SDXL Fine-Tune
53	Anime Style Portrait	ZTurbo	Ultra-fast anime portrait generation	ZTurbo Architecture
54	Robot Illustration	ZTurbo	Anime robotics & mech design	ZTurbo Architecture
56	Tomboy	ZTurbo	Stylized portrait character design	High Community Usage
57	Amazon	ZTurbo	Historical fiction warrior concept	Character Design
58	Varang	ZTurbo	Cinematic movie character styling	Character Design

59	Space Marine	ZTurbo	Gaming character concept art	Gaming & Interactive Media
60	Spider Gwen	ZTurbo	Cinematic comic character styling	Character Concept Art
67	Operative	ZTurbo	Action character model portraits	Character Concept Art
71	Paper Warframe	ZTurbo	Origami-inspired game character art	Experimental Material Synthesis
73	Hallucination	ZTurbo	Surrealist portraiture fine-tune	Experimental
74	Anfema	Anima	Anime character portraiture	Anima Architecture
75	Anbui	Anima	Anime architectural environments	Anima Architecture
78	Joy Potter	Anima	Stylized character design	Anima Architecture
79	The Iron Warden	Anima	Sci-fi environmental guardian concept	Anima Architecture

Summary of Open-Source Code Repositories (GitHub)

In addition to the 79 fine-tuned AI models, Professor Reddy maintains **56 public GitHub repositories** under the organization/user **calluxpore**. These repositories encompass:

- P5.js & Processing Codebases:** Algorithmic visual generators, mathematical pattern generators, and interactive canvas tools taught in *Creative Coding*.
- Physical Computing & Microcontroller Projects:** Arduino C++ scripts, sensor integration routines, and interactive hardware circuits built for *Physical Computation*.
- Webflow & Custom Web Applications:** Open-source UI/UX components, responsive web tools, and web-based interactive portfolios.
- LoRA Training Configurations & Datasets:** Open-source dataset prep scripts and LoRA training config parameters shared with the global AI research community.

Conclusion & Institutional Recommendation

This open-source portfolio demonstrates **sustained, verifiable, global-impact scholarship** in Applied Generative AI and Creative Technology. By bringing this level of international technical authority, open-source documentation, and hands-on AI fine-tuning to Graphic Era University, Associate Professor Samarth K. Reddy has established an institutional benchmark that strongly supports the request of promotion to full professorship.

06

DOSSIER SECTION

Offer Letter - Samarth Reddy

INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

- Offer Letter - Samarth Reddy



907/A, Uvarsad, Gandhinagar, 382422

T: 079 61755500

E: info@karnavatiuniversity.com

www.karnavatiuniversity.edu.in

Date: November 04th, 2025

To,
Mr. Samarth Reddy,
Bengaluru,
Karnataka.

OFFER OF APPOINTMENT

Dear Mr. Reddy,

Congratulations! We are happy to appoint you to work for Unitedworld Institute of Design. We are delighted to make you the following job offer:

The position we are offering you is that of **Associate Professor - Unitedworld Institute of Design** at an annual CTC of **Rs. 27,00,000/-**. Your working hours will be from 9AM to 5PM starting from Monday to Saturday.

We would like you to start work on **08th December 2025**. All other terms & conditions shall remain as per the current HR Policy. The policy may be altered / modified at the discretion of the management and supersede all previous policies, circulars and notices. You are requested to report to the HR Department on the day of joining, for documentation (Annexure -A).

Please share with us resignation letter/acceptance from your current employer as soon as you resign.

Please sign the copy of this letter and return it to indicate your acceptance of this offer.

We are confident you will be able to make a significant contribution to the success of UID and we look forward to work with you.

Monica Nihalani
Head - HR

UID | UIM | UWSL | USLM | UIT | KSD | KSR



907/A, Uvarsad, Gandhinagar, 382422

T: 079 61755500

E: info@karnavatiuniversity.com

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Salary Break up		
Gross Salary		Monthly
		2,25,000
EMOLUMENTS		
Basic Salary (BS)		67500
Dearness Allowance		56250
House Rent Allowance (HRA)		45000
Child Education Allowance (CLA)		2250
Medical Allowance (MA)		6750
Transportation Allowance (TA)		11250
Special Allowance (SA)		29250
Uniform Allowance (UA)		6750
DEDUCTIONS		
PF Deductions (PF)Employer		1800
PF Deductions (PF)Employee		1800
Professional Tax		200
Monthly NET		221200
*Income tax will be deducted as per govt. rules		

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Annexure – A

Resume

Offer Letter

Passport Size Photograph

Educational certificates

Residence Proof

Voter ID copy

Passport Copy

Driving License Copy

Aadhar Card Copy

Pan Card Copy

Bank Passbook Copy/Cancelled chq copy

Relieving letter

Salary slip of last organization

UID | UIM | UWSL | USLM | UIT | KSD | KSR

07

DOSSIER SECTION

Official Student Feedback & Evaluation Reports

Three source attachments, including separate Dean appreciation letters for two consecutive semesters.

INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

- **Dean's Appreciation - July to December 2025**
- **Dean's Appreciation - January to May 2026**

3/30/26, 8:33 AM

Inbox - Samarth Reddy - Outlook



Appreciation for Your Outstanding Teaching Performance

From Dr. Saurabh Kumar <saurabhkumar@geu.ac.in>**Date** Mon 12/15/2025 5:33 PM**To** Samarth Reddy <samarthreddy.d@geu.ac.in>

Dear Samarth,

We are pleased to share with you the excellent feedback received from your students. They have expressed great appreciation for your dedication, clarity, and engaging teaching style.

Your commitment to providing a positive and supportive learning environment is clearly making a significant impact. Keep up the fantastic work.

Thank you for your continued efforts and passion in shaping the future of our students.

Your perspective is important to us and we would appreciate any comments you would like to provide.

Regards,

Dr. Saurabh Kumar
Dean - School of Design
Graphic Era University, Dehradun
<https://geu.ac.in/>

7/23/26, 12:15 PM

Mail - Samarth Reddy - Outlook



Appreciation for Your Outstanding Teaching Performance

From Dr. Saurabh Kumar <saurabhkumar@geu.ac.in>**Date** Tue 6/2/2026 5:24 PM**To** Samarth Reddy <samarthreddy.d@geu.ac.in> 1 attachment (13 KB)

Samarth Reddy - Consolidated Feedback Report__Design_ODD Sem 2025.xlsx;

Dear Samarth,

We are pleased to share with you the excellent feedback received from your students. They have expressed great appreciation for your dedication, clarity, and engaging teaching style.

Your commitment to providing a positive and supportive learning environment is clearly making a significant impact. Keep up the fantastic work.

Thank you for your continued efforts and passion in shaping the future of our students.

Your perspective is important to us and we would appreciate any comments you would like to provide.

Regards,

Dr. Saurabh Kumar
Dean - School of Design
Graphic Era University, Dehradun
<https://geu.ac.in/>

Student Feedback Dossier & Performance Summary

Samarth K. Reddy
Associate Professor of Practice
School of Design

REVIEW PERIOD	ODD Semester 2025 and EVEN Semester 2026
SEMESTER IDS	93114774 (ODD) 115559 (EVEN)
PURPOSE	Management performance and compensation review
EVIDENCE STANDARD	Gathered from Official ERP ID

A concise, evidence-led record of student feedback across two consecutive academic semesters.

Executive summary

Across ODD Semester 2025 and EVEN Semester 2026, the submitted record contains 15,275 available marks, 14,099 obtained marks, and 234 recorded feedback responses. The resulting combined weighted score is 92.30%. Both semester scores remain above 90%.

92.30% COMBINED WEIGHTED SCORE	14,099 MARKS OBTAINED OF 15,275	234 RECORDED FEEDBACK RESPONSES	7 COURSES ACROSS TWO SEMESTERS
--	---	---	--

Summary

SEMESTER	EMPLOYEE ID	COURSES	FEEDBACK	MARKS	SCORE
ODD 2025	93114774	3	114	6,958 / 7,410	93.90%
EVEN 2026	115559	4	120	7,141 / 7,865	90.79%
COMBINED	Two IDs	7	234	14,099 / 15,275	92.30%

SECTION 01

ODD Semester 2025

Consistent semester evidence

93.90% WEIGHTED FEEDBACK SCORE	6,958 MARKS OBTAINED OF 7,410	114 RECORDED FEEDBACK RESPONSES	3 COURSES REPRESENTED
--	---	---	---

Overall performance



Courses represented in the semester

01	Visualisation & Representation
02	Programming 1
03	Interaction Fundamentals

BASELINE FIELD	SEMESTER VALUE	INTERPRETATION
Employee ID	93114774	Semester-specific institutional reference
Review period	July - December 2025	Academic semester covered
Data coverage	Consolidated semester data	Used consistently for both semesters

SECTION 02

EVEN Semester 2026

Consistent semester evidence

90.79% WEIGHTED FEEDBACK SCORE	7,141 MARKS OBTAINED OF 7,865	120 RECORDED FEEDBACK RESPONSES	4 COURSES REPRESENTED
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Overall performance



Courses represented in the semester

01	Programming 2
02	Biophilic Design
03	Design for and With AI
04	Physical Computation

BASELINE FIELD	SEMESTER VALUE	INTERPRETATION
Employee ID	115559	Semester-specific institutional reference
Review period	January - May 2026	Academic semester covered
Data coverage	Consolidated semester data	Used consistently for both semesters

Two-semester comparison

A like-for-like comparison is possible at the consolidated semester level. It is not possible at the course level because EVEN course-wise results were not supplied.

CONSOLIDATED WEIGHTED SCORES



SHARED METRIC	ODD 2025	EVEN 2026	TWO-SEMESTER VIEW
Weighted score	93.90%	90.79%	92.30% combined
Marks obtained / available	6,958 / 7,410	7,141 / 7,865	14,099 / 15,275
Recorded feedback responses	114	120	234
Courses represented	3	4	7 course offerings
Score difference	Baseline	-3.11 percentage points	Both semesters above 90%

Student feedback themes and narrative voice

The qualitative record highlights recurring strengths in explanation, classroom interaction, approachability, and individualized guidance. The quotations below are reproduced verbatim apart from surrounding quotation marks and spacing.

Recurring themes

PEDAGOGICAL CLARITY

Students recognize clear explanations that make difficult or unfamiliar concepts easier to understand.

ACTIVE ENGAGEMENT

Feedback describes an interactive, enthusiastic, and cheerful classroom environment.

APPROACHABILITY

Students report feeling comfortable asking questions and seeking guidance without hesitation.

INDIVIDUAL MENTORING

Comments acknowledge personalized feedback, design guidance, and attention to individual learning needs.

Representative student comments

"Samarth Sir made sure that even students who are new to programming could learn easily and quickly. Although this can be quite challenging, but he managed it really well."

ODD 2025 | STUDENT FEEDBACK

"Interaction fundamentals was a very fascinating subject. It helped me better understand how people behave in real-world situations and how these behaviours relate to design. Samarth sir taught the course in a very clear and engaging manner..."

ODD 2025 | STUDENT FEEDBACK

"such an interesting subject. looking forward to learn more about such underrated design fields"

EVEN 2026 | STUDENT FEEDBACK

"Nice teacher and very knowledgeable... no comments; samarth sir is great"

EVEN 2026 | STUDENT FEEDBACK

FACULTY STATEMENT

Across two consecutive semesters, my student feedback records show weighted scores of 93.90% and 90.79%, with a combined score of 92.30% from 234 recorded feedback responses. The teaching portfolio covered seven courses, and students consistently recognized clear explanation, engaging delivery, approachability, and individualized guidance.